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Dear Readers,

Every newspaper tells its story not just through the news it carries, but also through how it presents it. Today, *Millennium Post* turns a new page – with a refreshed design built for how you read today, without losing sight of the principles that have guided us since our inception.

You'll notice a redesigned layout, a refreshed masthead and a new typeface, chosen to make your reading experience cleaner, more engaging and easier to navigate. An improved column grid, sharper spacing and a stronger visual hierarchy give important stories the prominence they deserve, in print and in our digital replica alike.

This is more than a visual makeover. In an age of endless digital noise, print journalism still stands apart for its credibility, accuracy and fairness. As a young, growing newspaper, this redesign reflects our commitment to evolving with our readers, while staying true to the journalism you trust us for.

We hope you enjoy the new look. As always, you are at the heart of everything we do; write to us at editor@millenniumpost.in with your thoughts.

Durbar Ganguly
(EDITOR-IN-CHIEF)

Centre eyes joint panel review of FCRA Bill amid Oppn pushback

State of border will dictate overall ties with China: India

Bill regulates foreign funding: Govt; Oppn says it hurts minority institutions

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, August 11

The government is considering referring the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 to a joint committee of both Houses of Parliament for further scrutiny, even as several opposition parties have demanded that the proposed legislation be withdrawn, sources said on Tuesday.

According to government sources, a motion to send the Bill to the joint committee may be introduced in the Lok Sabha on Wednesday. The proposal comes amid growing political opposition to the legislation, which seeks to tighten oversight of non-governmental organisations (NGOs) receiving



Rajya Sabha proceedings underway

KEY POINTS

- » Motion for referral likely in Lok Sabha on Wednesday
- » Opposition alleges Bill disproportionately affects minority institutions and Christian NGOs

- » Bill was introduced in Lok Sabha on March 25
- » Bill proposes tighter oversight of NGOs receiving foreign funds
- » Asset management authority proposed for cancelled FCRA licence holders

foreign funds. The issue figured during a meeting of the Business Advisory Committee

namool Congress (TMC) sought clarity on when the Bill would be taken up in the House. The government responded that a decision would be taken at an appropriate time.

While the Congress and TMC called for the Bill's withdrawal, the Biju Janata Dal (BJD) supported the idea of sending it to a joint parliamentary committee for detailed examination. The DMK also reiterated its demand for the legislation to be withdrawn. Party leaders Tiruchi Siva and P Wilson later said the DMK had conveyed the same position during the BAC meeting.

Introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25, the Bill proposes stricter regulation of foreign contributions and includes provisions to create a

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 11

India on Tuesday said peace and tranquillity along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) remain central to the future of its relationship with China, reiterating that the condition of the border will shape the broader trajectory of bilateral ties. The statement came amid unconfirmed reports of aggressive posturing by Chinese troops in Arunachal Pradesh's Upper Subansiri district in late July and as New Delhi once again rejected Beijing's objections to India's naming of 27 places in Arunachal Pradesh, asserting that the state is an "inalienable and integral" part of the country.

Responding to questions at the Ministry of External Affairs' weekly

Assessing Pakistan-Saudi-Turkiye defence pact, says India

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday said it is assessing the implications of the new defence agreement signed by Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Türkiye from the perspective of national security as well as regional peace and stability.

The Makkah Joint Defence Agreement was signed on August 7 after talks between Pakistan **CONTINUED ON P4**

media briefing, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India has consistently **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

Govt approves polymer notes of Rs 10 and 20

NEW DELHI: The Centre has approved the Reserve Bank of India's proposal to introduce one billion polymer banknotes each in the Rs 10 and Rs 20 denominations for field trials, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman informed the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday. In a written reply, she said the notes will be issued **CONTINUED ON P4**

Prez gives assent to 'Vande Mataram' Bill

NEW DELHI: President Droupadi Murmu on Tuesday gave her assent to the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, making it a law that extends legal protection to the national song 'Vande Mataram' on par with the national anthem 'Jana Gana Mana'. According to a government statement, **CONTINUED ON P4**

Himachal reels under monsoon fury

Toll climbs to 157 as 259 roads remain blocked, more rain forecast



ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, August 11

Himachal Pradesh remains in the grip of a severe monsoon crisis, with 157 people killed, 257 reported missing and 259 roads blocked as relentless rain, landslides and flash floods continue to disrupt life across the state. Nearly 900 public assets and private properties have been damaged, taking the estimated losses to around Rs 886 crore, while authori-

ties continue restoration work amid forecasts of more heavy rainfall over the coming days.

According to the latest State Emergency Operations Centre (SEOC) report covering the period from June 30 to August 9, 68 people lost their lives in landslides and flash floods, while another 89 were killed in road accidents linked to the monsoon. Officials said the damage has spread across roads, bridges, **CONTINUED ON P4**

US court permanently drops criminal case against Adani

MPOST BUREAU
New York/New Delhi, Aug 11

A US federal judge has permanently dismissed the main criminal charges against Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani, his nephew Sagar Adani and former Adani Green Energy CEO Vneet Jaani, ending a major legal challenge that had hung over the conglomer-

ate for nearly two years. US District Judge Nicholas Garaufis of the Eastern District of New York approved the Justice Department's request to dismiss the charges in a 47-page order issued on August 10. The ruling permanently drops Counts Two, Three and Four of the indictment, which covered securities **CONTINUED ON P4**

AI Phuket-Delhi flight pilot tests +ve for marijuana

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 11

The pilot-in-command of an Air India Phuket-Delhi flight that suddenly lost around 300 feet in altitude during cruise last week has tested positive for marijuana in a confirmatory psychoactive substance test, sources said on Tuesday, even as aviation authorities **CONTINUED ON P4**

NORMS TARGET DEBRIS, DUST & WASTE SPILLING

No more flying debris? New rules make covered truckloads must

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 11

The familiar sight of sand spilling from overloaded tippers, stones bouncing off highways or uncovered garbage trucks leaving a trail of foul smells may soon become less common on Indian roads. In a move aimed at making roads cleaner and safer, the Centre has made it mandatory for all tippers and dumpers to be fitted with automatic load-covering systems from April 1, 2027.

TAKEAWAYS

- » New rule aims to improve road safety and cleanliness
- » All load bodies must remain fully enclosed during travel
- » Covers can be electrical, electro mechanical, hydraulic or mechanical



- » Any suitable covering material is permitted under the rules
- » Rule applies to all tippers and dumpers

The new rules also require an audiovisual warning system inside the driver's cabin to alert the driver if the cover is left open while the vehicle is moving.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) notified the new requirements **CONTINUED ON P4**

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BMW runs over 48-year-old woman, villagers block road

Traffic diverted near IGIA T-3; heavy police force deployed

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

A 48-year-old woman was killed after she was hit by a speeding BMW car in Delhi's Mehram Nagar area on Tuesday, following which angry locals blocked a road, officials said.

The deceased was identified as Jaiwanti, who worked as a house help, they said, adding the car driver has been apprehended. According to police, the accident occurred at around 12 noon when Jaiwanti was crossing the road at a zebra crossing to go home for lunch. The impact was severe and the woman died on the spot.

An official said that a case has been registered and legal action has been initiated. The driver of the BMW allegedly involved in the accident was identified as Deepak (38), a resident of Pratap Nagar in Mandoli.

"We have apprehended the driver and further investigation is in progress," he said.

After the accident, local villagers gathered and blocked the road in protest, disrupting traffic movement in the area. Heavy police force, including paramilitary, was deployed to maintain law and order.



CLOSER LOOK

- » 'We have apprehended the driver and further investigation is in progress,' a police official stated
- » After the accident, local villagers gathered and blocked the road in protest, disrupting traffic movement in the area. Heavy police force, including paramilitary, was deployed to maintain law and order
- » Cops said that a PCR call reported that a car had hit a woman, after which they immediately reached the spot and found the victim had been shifted to DDU

was deployed to maintain law and order.

Police said that a PCR call reported that a car had hit a woman, after which they immediately reached the spot and found that the victim had already been shifted to DDU Hospital, where she was declared dead. "During initial inquiry, the deceased was

identified as Jaiwanti, a resident of East Mehram Nagar. It was revealed that while she was on the road, she was suddenly hit by the car," said the officer.

Police said that Deepak has been working as a driver for the last six months and was returning from the airport alone when the

accident occurred.

The victim's daughter-in-law said that her mother-in-law was returning home when the car hit her and fled the spot.

"She was returning home when the car hit her. We rushed to the spot after receiving the information and found her lying on the road. My husband immediately took her to the hospital and informed the police. We want justice for her," she said.

She further said that her husband had died around five years ago, and she had been earning for the family since then.

Jaiwanti's daughter alleged that the accused driver fled the spot after hitting her mother.

"The driver fled after hitting my mother. We wanted to meet him and ask him why he was driving so fast and why he did not slow down while passing through the area. If he had been driving carefully and at a controlled speed, perhaps this tragedy could have been avoided," she said. Villagers protested after the accident, disrupting traffic near IGI Airport's T-3, with police advising commuters to take alternative routes.

Noida woman dies in high-rise fall; family alleges harassment

DIPIKA KIROLA
Noida, August 11

A 24-year-old woman died after allegedly falling from a high-rise apartment in Noida's Sector 108 on Sunday evening, barely a month after her marriage, with her family later alleging that she had been harassed over dowry. Police are investigating both the circumstances surrounding her fall and the allegations made by her relatives.

The woman, a native of Etah, had been living with her husband in a rented flat in Lily Tower of Divine Meadows society. The couple got married on July 11 and moved into the apartment after their wedding. Her husband, originally from Dehradun, works as a video editor with a private company.

The incident was reported around 5.30pm after residents heard a loud sound and found the woman had allegedly fallen from the 16th floor of the building. Her family members rushed her to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared her dead on arrival.

Police reached the residential complex after being informed about the incident and began examining the circum-



“THE INCIDENT WAS REPORTED AROUND 5.30PM AFTER RESIDENTS HEARD A LOUD SOUND AND FOUND THE WOMAN HAD FALLEN FROM THE 16TH FLOOR

stances surrounding the death. The body was subsequently sent for a post-mortem examination.

Police said no suicide note was found at the spot. A forensic team has also been alerted and will examine the scene as part of the investigation.

During preliminary questioning, the woman's husband told police that she had been suffering from depression for some time and was undergoing treatment. Investigators are verifying the claim, however, as he was unable to immediately pro-

vide documents relating to the alleged treatment when asked by police.

Police are also examining the couple's recent interactions to determine whether there had been any dispute or confrontation between them before the woman allegedly fell from the building. Statements from her husband and others who may have information about the couple's relationship are being recorded.

The case took another turn after the woman's relatives arrived in Noida following news of her death. They accused her husband of harassing her in connection with dowry and questioned whether the circumstances surrounding her death were being adequately investigated.

The family has demanded that the allegations be thoroughly examined and that the death not be viewed in isolation as a suicide. Police said the allegations would be investigated along with all other possible circumstances surrounding the incident.

Police are awaiting the post-mortem and forensic reports while examining the woman's history and family's complaint. No conclusion has been reached, with further action based on evidence gathered.

Assam woman found dead in Noida PG, police hunt suspect

DIPIKA KIROLA
Noida, August 11

A 19-year-old woman from Assam was found dead in a blood-soaked condition inside a locked room at a paying guest accommodation in Baraula village on Sunday, with police suspecting that she was killed with a sharp-edged weapon.

The deceased was identified as Mahak Ahmed, a Class 12 passout from Dibrugarh. She had arrived in Noida around three weeks ago without informing her parents and was staying at the PG near Bansal temple with her 18-year-old friend, Sanjana, also from Assam.

The body was discovered after residents complained of a foul smell coming from a locked room on the first floor. The room belonged to Raman, a BTech graduate and former IT employee from Katihar, Bihar, who has been missing since the incident.

Police said Mahak had multiple injury marks, some apparently caused by a sharp-edged weapon. A forensic team examined the room and the body was sent for post-mortem.

Police arrest nine in Rs 15-cr cyber fraud

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

The Delhi Police has arrested nine persons allegedly associated with a pan-India investment fraud and cyber mule syndicate purportedly linked to 34 complaints involving more than Rs 15.71 crore, officials said on Tuesday.

The probe has also uncovered suspected links with persons based in Qatar, and alleged operational coordination with Dubai-based cybercriminals, they said. The accused Jamaluddin Faisal (30), Sarabjit Singh (43), Sonia Sharma (42), Shobh Dilavari Saiyyad (26), Siddiki Mahamadsiddik Mufidbhai (30), Shaikh Riyazuddin Imtiyaz (29), Hamza Humayu (26), Kamalsha Kadarshah (30) and Muzamil Thaib (20) were arrested from Kerala, Maharashtra, Gujarat and Punjab.

The case came to light after a Palam Colony resident alleged he was lured

into social media groups appearing to be investment-learning platforms. The accused allegedly impersonated market analysts and investment professionals, showed fabricated trading profits and persuaded him to invest through a fraudulent trading application, a senior officer said.

The victim initially transferred Rs 4.82 lakh through multiple bank accounts and was allowed a small withdrawal to inspire confidence.

He was subsequently asked to deposit another Rs 7.81 lakh on the pretext of an IPO allotment. Suspecting fraud, he filed a complaint on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP).

Police traced the cyber fraud network across states, arresting nine accused linked to shell firms and mule accounts. The syndicate was connected to 34 complaints involving Rs 15.71 crore.

Discoms urge safe kite flying ahead of Independence Day

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Power discoms have issued advisories ahead of Independence Day and Rakshabandhan, urging kite flyers to avoid metal-coated manjha, commonly known as Chinese manjha, and fly kites away from power lines and electrical installations.

BSES said metal-coated manjha can conduct electricity and cause electric shocks, electrocution, equipment damage and power disruptions. Tripping of a single 33/66 kV overhead line can affect more than 10,000 residents, while an 11 kV line can disrupt supply to over 2,500 residents. Its operations and maintenance teams are on high alert for kite-flying-related contingencies.

BSES urged residents to use cotton or other natural-fibre thread without metallic or glass components.

Cops bar kites & aerial objects near Red Fort

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 11

Delhi Police has banned kite flying and the use of other aerial objects near the Red Fort and Independence Day event venues in the Central district as part of heightened security measures.

The order, issued under Section 163 of the BNSS, remains effective till August 16. Police said the restriction aims to prevent potential threats and ensure public safety, law and order. Violations will attract action under Section 223 of the BNS.

nents. TPDDL also warned that metal-coated and glass-coated manjha can cause power-line tripping.

Mass singing of 'Vande Mataram' at Police HQ



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

The Delhi Police on Tuesday organised a mass singing of the National Song 'Vande Mataram' at its headquarters as part of the 'Har Ghar Tiranga 2026' campaign, an official said. The programme was held at the Adarsh Auditorium in the presence of Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and attended by senior officers and police personnel.

Delhi govt launches four mapped tourism circuits

Linking temples, gurdwaras...

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Tourists visiting Delhi will be able to explore the capital through the four curated tourism circuits connecting temples, gurdwaras, churches, Jain and Buddhist sites, archaeological landmarks and other attractions, as the government seeks to turn the city from a transit point into a destination.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the circuits – 'The Soul of Delhi', 'The Heritage of Delhi', 'Delhi's Sacred Harmony' and 'Echoes of Delhi' – at the Spiritual and Heritage Tourism Conclave-2026 at Akshardham Temple on

Tuesday. Spiritual leader Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev was also present.

The four routes cover 21 sites across the capital. The circuits combine spiritual, cultural and historical attractions, including Gurudwara Bangla Sahib, Sacred Heart Cathedral, Agrasen Ki Baoli, Lotus Temple, Akshardham Temple, Jantar Mantar, Purana Qila, Hazrat Nizamuddin and Mehrauli Archaeological Park.

Gupta said the initiative aims to encourage longer tourist stays and benefit hotels, restaurants, guides, artisans and local businesses while showcasing Delhi's diverse traditions.

DU student held in murder case

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Delhi Police's Crime Branch has arrested 23-year-old Delhi University student Sohail in connection with the March 4 murder of Tarun in Uttam Nagar following a family dispute.

Sohail, a resident of JJ Colony, Hastsal Road, was arrested near Palam Flyover on August 8 while allegedly trying to flee Delhi.

Police said he was declared a proclaimed offender on July 31. Sohail allegedly confessed to attacking Tarun with sticks and iron rods during a clash between the two families. He had reportedly stayed in Jaipur before returning to Delhi.

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Printed and Published by Jaiyendra Kumar Sharma on behalf of Front Row Media Pvt. Ltd. and printed at The Indian Express Pvt. Ltd., A-8, Sector-7, Noida-201 301 (U.P.) and published from First Floor, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002. Editor: Durbar Ganguly. Email: editor@millenniumpost.in, Tel. No. 011-47777500, Kolkata office: Room No 1, 15th Floor, Chatterjee International Centre, 33A Jawaharlar Nehru Road, Kolkata 700071 West Bengal, Siliguri Office: Techno India Group Zonal Office G-212, 2nd Floor Office Block - City Centre Matigara District Darjeeling Pin - 734010 Phone- 0353- 2576321

Four Bills, then the House adjourns

Bills cover fire safety, JJ rehabilitation, B&B sector, public services

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 11

The Delhi Assembly on Tuesday concluded its Monsoon Session with the passage of four significant Bills covering fire safety regulations, rehabilitation of jhuggi-jhopri (JJ) clusters, the bed-and-breakfast sector and time-bound delivery of public services. The proceedings, however, were dominated by a sharp political confrontation over Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) reports, while the House also witnessed high drama as Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) MLAs staged a protest over an alleged rice distribution scam, leading to two legislators being marshalled out.

FIRE SERVICE LAW AMENDED TO SIMPLIFY REGULATIONS

The Assembly passed the Delhi Fire Service (Amendment) Bill, 2026, amending Section 2(i) of the Delhi Fire Service Act, 2007 by replacing the words “building bye-laws/National Building Code of India” with only “building bye-laws.”

Introducing the Bill, Education and Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood said the amendment forms part of the Government of India’s deregulation exercise and seeks to simplify Delhi’s fire safety framework. He said that as most buildings in Delhi are governed through building bye-laws, removing the statutory reference



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta speaks during the Monsoon session of the Delhi Legislative Assembly

CAG ROW, RICE PROTEST

- » Chief Minister Rekha Gupta used the discussion on two CAG reports to launch a strong attack on the previous AAP government, describing the audit findings as its ‘report card’. She alleged irregularities in sectors including health, education, power subsidy, Delhi Jal Board, PWD and procurement
- » The House also witnessed uproar as AAP legislators protested over an alleged rice scam by carrying sacks of rice into the Assembly and throwing grains during proceedings

to the National Building Code would streamline regulations.

According to the government, the amendment ensures consistency with the proposed changes in the Delhi Fire Service Rules, 2010, where the reference to the National Building Code is also proposed to be omitted. It will enable fire prevention and safety standards to be prescribed and updated through the Unified Building Bye-Laws in line with Delhi’s evolving technical and regulatory requirements, without

requiring repeated amendments to the parent Act. The Bill does not involve any expenditure from the Consolidated Fund of the NCT of Delhi and does not confer any additional delegated legislative powers.

JJ REHABILITATION EXPANDED THROUGH DUSIB AMENDMENT

The House also approved the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (Amendment) Bill, 2026, changing the cut-off date for identifying eligible JJ clusters from January 1, 2006,

to January 1, 2025. Sood said the amendment aligns the DUSIB Act with the proposed Delhi Slum and Jhuggi Jhopri Rehabilitation and Relocation Policy, 2026, providing a contemporary framework for rehabilitation and relocation of eligible residents. He said the government would prioritise in-situ rehabilitation, allowing people to continue living near their workplaces instead of being shifted to distant locations.

The amendment enables settlements that came up between 2006 and 2025 to qualify for rehabilitation, subject to other conditions. It also permits private companies and slum cooperatives to participate in redevelopment projects. DUSIB will continue to provide essential civic amenities, including drinking water, drainage, toilets, bathing facilities and paved streets, while rehabilitation, relocation or in-situ upgradation may be undertaken with the consent of the landowner. The government acknowledged that expanding the definition of JJ clusters would increase DUSIB’s financial obligations towards rehabilitation and civic infrastructure.

During the discussion, AAP MLA Anil Jha urged the government to conduct a survey of JJ clusters demolished over the past two years and sought clarity on rehabilitation of settlements located on railway and DDA land. Sood rejected allegations that

jhuggis had been removed near his constituency and accused the previous AAP government of failing to fulfil its “Jahan Jhuggi Wahan Makaan” promise despite being in power for a decade.

17-YEAR-OLD BED AND BREAKFAST LAW REPEALED

The Assembly unanimously passed the Delhi Bed and Breakfast Establishments (Repeal) Bill, 2026, repealing the National Capital Territory of Delhi (Incredible India) Bed and Breakfast Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2007, along with its amendments of 2010 and 2021. The government said the hospitality and tourism sector has undergone major changes over the years, with new accommodation models making the existing legal framework outdated.

CITIZENS GET LEGAL RIGHT TO TIME-BOUND SERVICES

The Assembly also passed the Delhi (Right of Citizens to Time Bound and Ease of Delivery of Services) Bill, 2026, aimed at making government departments more accountable. IT Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh said citizens would be able to apply for notified services digitally and track their applications through a Unique Application Number. If services are not delivered within the prescribed timeline, applications will automatically be escalated to senior officers.

Viral clip puts MLA in spot

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday strongly criticised AAP MLA Anil Jha Vats after a video purportedly showing him sitting in his undergarments while signing documents for constituents went viral on social media. Raising the issue in the Delhi Assembly, the Chief Minister termed the conduct “shameful” and demanded strict action against the legislator.

The viral video reportedly shows the Kirari MLA seated cross-legged in a chair, wearing only a vest and shorts, with a saffron cloth placed across his lap, while signing application forms submitted by residents. Several women can also be seen standing in a queue before him. The forms were reportedly related to the Delhi government’s Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, under which eligible women receive Rs 2,500 per month as financial assistance.

TIRANGA SPIRIT



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and others take part in ‘Tiranga Yatra’, at Delhi Assembly premises

Tiranga takes centre stage at Janpath Subway Art Gallery

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 11

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Tuesday revived its subway art exhibition initiative with the inauguration of a 10-day exhibition themed on the national flag at the Jan-

path Subway Art Gallery in Connaught Place. Vice-Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal inaugurated the ‘Har Ghar Tiranga 2026 - Art Exhibition and Live Painting Workshop’, organised in collaboration with Nav Siddhartha Art Group. The exhibition, being held as

part of the Independence Day celebrations, features more than 50 artworks by artists across painting and sculpture. The works explore themes of India’s cultural heritage, freedom movement, national identity, unity and contemporary aspirations, using the Tricolour as a central motif.

Briefs

Debate, not disruption



NEW DELHI: Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra attacked Congress leader and Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, accusing him of disrupting Parliament and avoiding debate on important issues. Addressing a press conference, Malhotra challenged Rahul Gandhi and the Opposition to come to Parliament and discuss every issue, including the students’ movement, instead of disrupting proceedings.

Idli-sambar on its way

NEW DELHI: Idli-sambar will soon be on the plates of students in Delhi government schools, with the dish set to be introduced within two weeks under a revised PM-POSHAN menu that also replaces ragi halwa with wheat flour and chana masala, and vegetable dalia with jowar and bajra. The Directorate of Education has directed the schools and implementing agencies to make the necessary arrangements by August 24. The revised menu replaces some of the existing meal items and includes poori with black chana gravy, rice with chhole and mashed vegetables, poori with chhole, rice with dal and rice with kadhi, according to an order issued by the DoE on Monday.

GeM buys surge 156%

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Government procurement through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) in Delhi has recorded a 156 per cent year-on-year increase in the first four months of 2026-27, with purchases touching Rs 1,595 crore till July, prompting the national platform to recognise the Capital for its growing adoption of digital procurement. According to the Delhi government, the Capital has been honoured under the ‘Sustained Services Procurement Adoption’ category for increasing the use of GeM in government purchases and expanding services procurement through the platform.

Official data showed procurement through GeM increased from Rs.624 crore during the corresponding period last year to Rs.1,595 crore in FY 2026-27 (up to July). Total procurement through the portal stood at Rs.4,311 crore in FY 2025-26, a 41 per cent increase over the

previous financial year. Of this, procurement from micro and small enterprises (MSEs) accounted for Rs.2,177 crore. The government said procurement from MSEs has more than doubled over the past four years, rising from around Rs.965 crore in FY 2021-22 to Rs 2,177 crore in FY 2025-26. Nearly 95 per cent of the orders received by Delhi-based sellers during the last financial year came from Central government departments and buyers in other states.

The platform has also expanded opportunities for underrepresented businesses. During FY 2025-26, procurement worth Rs.315 crore was made from women entrepreneurs, Rs.41 crore from SC/ST entrepreneurs and Rs.405 crore from startups.

The government said it organised over 65 training programmes involving more than 3,600 participants to increase awareness and improve adoption of the platform across departments.

Teej colours take over Dilli

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

The Delhi Tourism Department inaugurated a two-day Teej festival at Dilli Haat INA and Pitampura, bringing together traditional cultural activities, competitions, handicrafts and cuisine as part of the celebrations.

CM Rekha Gupta inaugurated the festival at Dilli Haat INA in the presence of Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra, Greater Kailash MLA Shikha Rai and Delhi Tourism Managing Director Sunil Anchipakka, among others. The festival, being held on August 8 and 9, seeks to showcase Teej as a celebration of cultural heritage, nature and traditional values. Organisers said the event aims to promote themes of harmony, love and beauty while providing visitors an opportunity to experience traditional festivities. A range of competitions, including mehendi, bindi and rangoli, are being organised during the festival, with prizes for winners.

Rain, clouds shroud Delhi

Capital sees widespread traffic snarls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Cloudy skies and rain shrouded the national capital on Tuesday, with several parts of the city reporting traffic snarls amid rainfall, traffic restrictions and movements linked to the Kanwar Yatra, which concludes today.

Between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, Safdarjung recorded 4 mm of rainfall, while Palam, Lodi Road, Ridge and Ayanagar received 1.4 mm, 1.5 mm, 3.7 mm and 1.6 mm, respectively.

Pusa recorded 3 mm, Najafgarh 1.5 mm and Mayur Vihar 3 mm during the period, according to the India Meteorological

RAINY RUSH

- » The congestion was attributed to multiple factors, including the rain, ongoing traffic restrictions, and the Kanwar Yatra
- » The IMD has forecast light rain or drizzle in the national capital till August 17



Department (IMD). Traffic congestion was noted on several major

routes, including NH-24, Ashram, and Safdarjung flyover, as well as Kashmiri Gate, ITO, Mathura Road, Vikas Marg, Delhi-Meerut Expressway, GT Road, and the Delhi-Haridwar highway.

The congestion was attributed to multiple factors, including the rain, ongoing traffic restrictions, and the Kanwar Yatra.

In the 24 hours ending at 8.30 am, Safdarjung recorded 4 mm of rainfall, while Lodi Road and Ridge received 4.8 mm and 6.9 mm, respectively.

Palam and Ayanagar recorded trace rainfall. Raighat recorded 10.6 mm, Pusa 4 mm and Mayur Vihar 38 mm during the same period.



स्वतंत्रता दिवस - 2026
INDEPENDENCE DAY - 2026



ENTRY

प्रवेश केवल निमंत्रण कार्ड के माध्यम से ही होगा।

ENTRY

✗

आगंतुकों के लिए निम्नलिखित वस्तुएं वर्जित हैं

✗



खाने-पीने की चीज़ें, केचप, सॉस
Eatables, Ketchup, Sauce



थैला, ब्रीफकेस, रिमोट नियंत्रित कार लॉक चाबियाँ
Bag, Briefcase, Remote Controlled Car Lock Keys



रेडियो, ट्रांजिस्टर, टेपरिकॉर्डर, पेजर
Radio, Transistor, Tape Recorder, Pager



कैमरा, दूरबीन, हैंड्युकैम
Camera, binoculars, Handycam



थर्मस, पानी की बोतल, कैन, छाता
Thermo Flask, Water Bottle, Cans, Umbrella



पटाखे, बारूद, फ्लेयर्स, किसी भी प्रकार के विस्फोटक
Firecrackers, Gunpowder, Flares, Any Type of Explosives



डिजिटल डायरियाँ, पाम-टॉप कंप्यूटर, लेपटॉप, डीवीडी / सीडी प्लेयर, डीवीडी / सीडी, आईपैड, आईफोन, टैबलेट, पेनड्राइव
Digital Diaries, Palm-top Computer, Laptop, Tablet, DVD/CD Player, DVD/CD, I-Pad, I-Pod, Pendrive



सिगरेट, बीड़ी, लाईटर
Cigarettes, Bidi, Lighter



ज्वलनशील पदार्थ, माचिस, शराब, एरोसोल, जेल / पेस्ट, इत्र, स्प्रे इत्यादि
Fuel, Matchbox, Alcohol, Aerosol, Gel/Paste, Perfumes, Spray etc.



हथौड़े, ड्रिल, आरी, तलवार, कटार, पेंचकस
Hammers, Drills, Saws, Sword, Dagger, Screw Driver



मोबाइल चार्जर, इयरफोन, पावर बैंक, बैटरी
Mobile Charger, Earphone, Power Bank, Battery



रेज़र, ब्लेड, चाकू, कैंची, तार, नुकीला हथियार
Razors, Blades, Knives, Scissors, Wires, Cutting /Sharp Pointed Edged Material



गोला-बारूद, आग्नेयास्त्र, खिलौना बंदूकें
Ammunitions, Firearms, Toy Guns



निष्क्रिय करने वाले रसायन और अन्य खतरनाक वस्तुएं
Disabling Chemicals and Other Dangerous Items

यदि कोई लावारिस वस्तु दिखाई दें, तो निकटतम सुरक्षाकर्मी के नोटिस में लाएं

Suspicious objects, if any may be brought to the notice of the nearest Security Personnel

Please co-operate with Police during searching/frisking

कृपया तलाशी देने में पुलिस के साथ सहयोग करें

Please be alert to your surroundings

कृपया अपने आस पास नज़र रखें

Email to CP, Delhi at: cpdelhi@delhipolice.gov.in | Write to CP, Delhi at: P.O. Box No. 171, GPO, New Delhi

@DelhiPoliceOfficial @DelhiPolice @delhi.police_official @DelhiPoliceofficial delhipolice.gov.in

FOR IMMEDIATE POLICE HELP, CALL 112 TO SHARE ANTI TERRORIST ACTIVITIES, CALL 14547

DP/9899/2026

From page 1

Centre eyes joint panel

designated authority to manage and dispose of the assets of organisations whose FCRA licences are cancelled.

Opposition parties have argued that the proposed changes could affect minority institutions and civil society groups. They claim some provisions may restrict legitimate foreign funding for Christian NGOs and minority-run educational and welfare organisations.

Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma and leading Christian organisations had earlier urged the Centre to send the Bill to a joint parliamentary committee for detailed scrutiny. They had met Union Home Minister Amit Shah to express their concerns over the proposed amendments.

DMK MP P Wilson also led a delegation of Church leaders to meet Shah, seeking withdrawal of the Bill and the repeal of Section 15 of the existing law. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister and DMK president M K Stalin has also urged the Centre to withdraw the proposed legislation.

The government, however, has maintained that the Bill is not directed at any religion and is intended only to regulate foreign contributions through a transparent legal framework.

Congress leader K C Venugopal strongly opposed the legislation, alleging that it targets minorities and NGOs. “Even if Amit Shah comes to pass this anti-people bill, there is no doubt that he will have to face strong protests in Parliament. This bill is unconstitutional and anti-people. We will not allow such an anti-people and unconstitutional bill to be passed,” he had said.

NCP (SP) working president Supriya Sule also opposed the Bill in its current form, saying foreign funding should not always be viewed with suspicion. She urged the government either to withdraw the legislation or refer it to a joint committee.

The proposed amendments have also drawn attention overseas. Several US lawmakers from both Democratic and Republican parties, including Senator James Risch, chairman of the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, raised concerns that the changes could affect Christian organisations and other civil society groups.

India rejected the criticism, calling the matter an internal legislative issue. External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the proposed amendments relate to India’s domestic lawmaking process.

India’s Ambassador to the US, Vinay Mohan Kwatra, said the amendments aim to improve transparency in foreign funding and ensure organisations receive overseas contributions through a prescribed process. In a series of posts on X, he said regulating foreign financial flows is a sovereign decision linked to national security and pointed to similar laws in the US, Australia, Canada, the UK and the European Union.

Tuesday’s BAC meeting was chaired by Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan and attended by Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, Leader of the House J P Nadda, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh, DMK’s Tiruchi Siva and BJD’s Sasmit Patra, among others.

The committee also allocated two hours each for the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 and the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, three hours for the National Co-operative Development Corporation (Amendment) Bill, 2026, and one-and-a-half hours for the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026. Deputy Chairman Harivansh later announced the BAC’s decisions in the Rajya Sabha.

State of border will dictate

conveyed to China that bor-

der-related issues are of the “most serious” nature and that maintaining peace in border areas is of the “utmost importance”.

“We have also stated that the state of the border affairs will reflect on the state of our larger bilateral ties,” Jaiswal said.

His remarks came against the backdrop of reports of a face-off between Indian and Chinese patrols in Upper Subansiri district. The Indian Army has not commented on the reports.

Jaiswal referred to the 36th meeting of the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) on India-China Border Affairs, held on August 6, where officials from both countries reviewed the situation along the LAC and held what he described as frank discussions.

“The Indian side again underlined that maintaining peace and tranquillity in the border areas is essential for the overall development of bilateral relations,” he said.

According to the MEA, both sides agreed to continue using existing diplomatic and military channels, including the WMCC, local commander-level meetings and other agreed mechanisms, to resolve pending issues and prevent misunderstandings or miscalculations along the LAC.

India also firmly rejected China’s criticism of its decision to formally identify 27 places and geographical features in Arunachal Pradesh using their standard names as recorded by the Survey of India. The move followed repeated attempts by Beijing to assign Chinese names to locations in the northeastern state.

“Arunachal is an inalienable and integral part of India and this is a fact which is self-evident. At the same time, let me also underline that nothing can change this indisputable reality,” Jaiswal said.

New Delhi has consistently maintained that changing names of places within Indian territory does not alter the reality of its sovereignty over the region.

The latest remarks come as India and China continue efforts to stabilise ties after relations deteriorated sharply following the 2020 Galwan Valley clashes and the military standoff that continued for more than four years. In October 2024, the two countries finalised a disengagement agreement covering Depsang and Demchok, the last remaining friction points in eastern Ladakh.

The agreement was followed by talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping in Kazan, where both leaders agreed on steps to improve bilateral relations. Last year, Modi also met Xi on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Tianjin, where he said India was committed to taking forward ties with China on the basis of mutual trust, mutual respect and mutual sensitivity.

India is also preparing to host the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13, where China will participate as a key member. Even as both countries engage through multi-lateral platforms, New Delhi has maintained that cooperation in such forums cannot be separated from the need for stability and peace along the border.

Assessing of Pak-Saudi-Turkiye

Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman and Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan.

Responding to questions at his weekly media briefing, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said, “As far as this agreement is concerned, we are examining its implications both from the perspective of India’s national security and considerations of regional peace and stability.”

He added, “India remains fully committed to safeguarding its national interests and will take all necessary measures in this regard.”

Jaiswal also said India was closely monitoring developments in the ongoing West Asia conflict.

According to a joint statement issued by the three countries on Friday, the agreement aims to strengthen collective deterrence against aggression and states that an armed attack on any one of the three countries will be treated as an attack on all. It also seeks to expand defence cooperation.

On separate questions about events supporting Balochistan’s “independence” and protests in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, Jaiswal alleged serious human rights violations in PoK. He said public protests there were met with “bullets, blackouts, repression and oppression” and urged the international community to hold Pakistan accountable for alleged abuses and cross-border terrorism.

MPOST

Monsoon fury

electricity infrastructure and water supply systems, posing major challenges for rescue and repair teams.

Landslides and debris have forced the closure of 259 roads across the state. Mandi district has been hit the hardest, with 120 roads shut, including the crucial Mandi-Kullu highway. Chamba has 42 blocked roads, followed by Kullu with 40 and Shimla with 30. Authorities said road-clearing operations are continuing, but recurring landslides triggered by fresh rainfall are delaying efforts to restore connectivity.

Power supply has also suffered extensive disruption. The SEOC said 161 distribution transformers have remained out of service for more than a week. Mandi accounts for 77 affected transformers, while Shimla has 43 and Kullu 40. Drinking water supply has also been hit, with 54 water schemes disrupted across the state. Shimla has reported the highest number of affected schemes at 33, followed by Chamba with 16 and Hamirpur with five.

The heavy rain has caused rivers and streams to swell rapidly, particularly in Kullu district, where videos from several locations showed flash floods carrying away vehicles and temporary bridges while debris tumbled down mountain slopes.

Fresh incidents continued to be reported on Tuesday. Police said one person died and two others were injured after a large rock crashed onto their moving car in the Bhararighat area of Solan district. In Kullu’s Anni area, a landslide damaged two parked vehicles near the new bus stand. Landslides were also reported from Shimla city, where debris damaged several two-wheelers.

As a precautionary measure, all schools, colleges and other educational institutions in Kullu subdivision remained closed on Tuesday. Sub-Divisional Magistrate Jaibanti Thakur ordered the closure after the India Meteorological Department warned of heavy to very heavy rainfall that could trigger landslides, flash floods and road blockades.

The weather department has issued an orange alert for heavy rainfall in Kangra, Mandi, Hamirpur, Shimla and Sirmaur districts. Moderate to heavy rain is also expected in Chamba, Kullu, Solan and Bilaspur. Separately, the Shimla Meteorological Centre has forecast a wet spell across Himachal Pradesh until August 17 and issued an orange alert for heavy to very heavy rainfall at isolated places in Sirmaur on Friday.

Heavy rainfall was recorded across several parts of the state between Monday evening and Tuesday. Bajaura received 101.5 mm of rain, followed by Bhattiyat with 95.2 mm, Dharamshala 94.3 mm, Palampur 66.4 mm, Bhuntar 58.6 mm, Kangra 55.4 mm, Jot 51 mm and Joginder-nagar 50 mm. Rain was also recorded in Pandoh, Sujampur Tira, Sarahan, Nagrota Suriyan, Kotkhai and Nahan.

The rainfall brought down daytime temperatures across the state. Una recorded the highest maximum temperature at 30.2 degrees Celsius, while Kukumseri remained the coldest at night with a minimum temperature of 12.5 degrees Celsius.

An earlier SEOC update issued on Tuesday evening had reported 204 blocked roads, 82 affected water supply schemes and 45 damaged transformers,

highlighting the rapidly changing situation as fresh rain continues to trigger new disruptions.

The monsoon’s impact has extended beyond Himachal Pradesh. In neighbouring Uttarakhand, a metal bridge in Chamoli district’s Niti Valley was swept away by powerful floodwaters, illustrating the widespread damage being caused across the Himalayan region as the monsoon continues.

Adani

fraud, securities fraud conspiracy and wire fraud conspiracy. The dismissal was made with prejudice, meaning the charges cannot be filed again.

However, Garaufis reserved judgment on Count One, alleging violations of the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act, and Count Five, alleging conspiracy to obstruct justice. Those counts involve five India-based defendants who have not appeared before the court. The Justice Department has until August 31 to satisfy the court’s requirements, while lawyers for the non-appearing defendants must confirm their clients’ consent by the same date.

The judge made it clear that the ruling should not be viewed as a finding on the allegations. “No one should mistake” the dismissal as the court’s agreement with the government’s decision, Garaufis wrote, noting that no trial had taken place, no witnesses had testified and no evidence had been tested.

The indictment, returned by a grand jury in October 2024 and unsealed the following month, alleged that between 2020 and 2024 Adani executives paid about USD 265 million in bribes to Indian officials to secure solar power contracts expected to generate more than USD 2 billion in after-tax profits over 20 years. Prosecutors also alleged investors were misled to raise nearly USD 4 billion in financing and that evidence was destroyed while false statements were made to the FBI, the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and a federal grand jury. The Adani Group consistently denied the allegations, saying it acted in accordance with applicable laws.

In May, the Justice Department sought dismissal after an extensive review, citing jurisdictional and evidentiary challenges, the largely Indian nature of the alleged conduct, scrutiny by Indian authorities, the absence of identified investor losses and a conclusion that continuing the prosecution no longer aligned with its priorities. It also argued that the case had little realistic prospect of reaching trial.

The request followed the appointment of a new legal team led by Robert J. Giuffra Jr. Garaufis initially questioned the government’s reasoning and sought further explanation. He also examined whether Adani’s November 2024 pledge to invest USD 10 billion in the United States and create 15,000 jobs had influenced the decision. Adani’s lawyers denied any connection between the investment and the case, and the judge ultimately concluded that the pledge had not affected the Justice Department’s decision.

Responding to the ruling, Adani said he accepted it with “humility” and “deep respect” for the judicial process. “Truth has prevailed,” he wrote on X, adding, “Throughout this challenging period, our faith in truth, fairness and the rule of law remained unwavering.” He also reaffirmed the Group’s commitment to nation-building and long-term value creation.

According to the Group, its legal team submitted about 600 pages of legal arguments, expert reports and presentations to the Justice Department between February and April 2026. The submissions included expert opinions from a Harvard Law School professor, a former acting SEC chair, a former Chief Justice of India and a former chairman of India’s Central Electricity Authority. Giuffra said the effort involved “many thousands of hours.”

The Adani Group said the litigation did not interrupt its operations or expansion plans. It invested more than Rs 2.08 lakh crore during the second

half of FY25 and FY26, including a record capital expenditure of Rs 1,52,967 crore in FY26. Its asset base grew from Rs 4.12 lakh crore in FY23 to Rs 7.85 lakh crore in FY26, while projects including Navi Mumbai International Airport, the Colombo West International Terminal and the Ganga Expressway became operational. Adani Ports handled more than 500 million tonnes of cargo in a financial year for the first time, while Adani Green Energy crossed 20 gigawatts of operational renewable capacity. The Group also said investors such as Apollo Global Management, BlackRock and Capital Group expanded their holdings, while partnerships with Google, MSC, IHC, EdgeConneX, Embraer and Dioxyle grew.

Although Garaufis approved the dismissal, he criticised the Justice Department’s handling of the case. He described the process as “highly unusual” and questioned the role of Principal Associate Deputy Attorney General R. Trent McCotter, saying he worked with Adani’s lawyers without consulting prosecutors and investigators who handled the original case. The judge rejected most of the government’s reasons for dropping the prosecution, including arguments that the matter was essentially foreign and outside US securities jurisdiction. However, he accepted one argument, finding that statements in Adani Green’s bond and loan documents about anti-corruption policies and compliance measures could amount to “inactionable puffery,” supporting dismissal of the three fraud-related counts.

Separately, Gautam Adani remains subject to an SEC civil judgment under which he consented to permanent injunctions relating to specified US securities law provisions without admitting the allegations, except as to jurisdiction. On the same day the criminal dismissal request was filed, the US Treasury Department’s Office of Foreign Assets Control announced a USD 275 million settlement with Adani Enterprises over apparent violations of US sanctions on Iran, describing the conduct as “egregious” while also noting the company’s extensive cooperation with the investigation.

Marijuana

widen their investigation into the incident that left 24 people injured. The development came as Civil Aviation Minister K Ram-mohan Naidu held a high-level meeting with Air India Chief Executive Officer Campbell Wilson and senior airline officials, stressing that aviation safety remains the government’s highest priority and warning that regulations would be strengthened if required.

The incident occurred on August 4 when Air India’s Airbus A320 aircraft, registered as VT-EXO, was operating flight AI 2379 from Phuket to Delhi. The aircraft experienced a sudden altitude variation of about 300 feet while cruising before regaining stability and landing safely in the national capital.

According to the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB), 20 passengers and four cabin crew members were injured. The aircraft was carrying 137 passengers, including three infants, and eight crew members comprising two pilots and six cabin crew members.

Following the incident, both pilots underwent mandatory psychoactive substance screening as required under Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) rules. The Civil Aviation Ministry had earlier said that the pilot-in-command’s initial screening indicated a result requiring confirmatory testing and that samples had been sent to a designated laboratory.

Sources said the confirmatory test has now also returned positive for marijuana. There has been no official statement from either Air India or the authorities on the laboratory findings.

Pending completion of the investigation and testing process, the DGCA has removed both pilots from flying duties.

Speaking after Tuesday’s meeting, Naidu said there could be no compromise on aviation

safety.

“Safety in aviation is the top-most priority, and there should not be any compromise from any side,” he said.

On the issue of psychoactive substance use among aviation personnel, the minister said the government was treating the matter with utmost seriousness and was prepared to revise regulations if necessary.

“We are continuously studying it and DGCA also, we have asked for updates on that. We are taking it very seriously. If we feel that present regulations are not up to the mark, then we will respond very seriously and improve whatever needs to be done,” he told reporters.

Under existing DGCA norms, aviation personnel testing positive for drugs are referred to a rehabilitation programme. A second positive test leads to suspension of the licence for three years, while a third violation results in cancellation of the licence.

The meeting at the Civil Aviation Ministry was attended by Wilson, Executive Advisor to Air India Chairman and former Civil Aviation Secretary Pradeep Singh Kharola, and the airline’s Head of Flight Safety Deepak Joshi. Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha, DGCA Director General Vir Vikram Yadav and AAIB Director General G V G Yugandhar also participated.

The ministry called Air India executives following the August 4 incident involving flight AI 2379.

Sources had said on Monday that the aircraft also experienced multiple technical glitches, hydraulic failures and turbulence during the flight. Investigators are examining all aspects before determining whether any of these factors contributed to the altitude deviation.

The AAIB, which has launched a formal investigation under applicable Indian regulations and International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) standards, said the inquiry is being supported by France’s Bureau d’Enquêtes et d’Analyses pour la sécurité de l’aviation civile (BEA) and Airbus, which are providing technical expertise and aircraft design information.

According to the investigation agency, the inquiry covers technical, operational, medical and human factors. Investigators are examining the aircraft and its systems, recorded flight data, operational and maintenance records, medical information, and conducting interviews with crew members and other concerned persons.

“The investigation is independent, evidence-based and comprehensive, and no inference regarding the cause of the occurrence should be drawn from any isolated piece of information while the investigation is in progress,” the AAIB said.

The bureau also urged the media and the public not to speculate on the cause of the incident, noting that several documents, records and medical reports connected to the investigation remain confidential until the process is completed.

It said the objective of the inquiry is to establish the circumstances and contributing factors behind the occurrence, recommend safety measures to prevent similar incidents, and submit a preliminary report within the timeframe prescribed under ICAO protocols.

No more flying debris?

on July 28 under the Central Motor Vehicles (Twelfth Amendment) Rules, 2026. The notification was published in the Gazette of India on August 7, amending the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, to introduce stricter safety standards for vehicles transporting loose and bulk materials.

From April 1 next year, every tipper and dumper will have to be equipped with a mechanism that covers the load body from the top while the vehicle is on the road. The load body is the rear container used to carry materials such as sand, gravel, soil, construction debris and other bulk cargo.

The rules allow the covering system to be electrically

operated, electromechanical, hydraulic or mechanical. Any suitable material may be used for the cover, provided it fully encloses the load during road movement. According to the notification, the objective is to ensure that “the load body remains fully enclosed during road movement”.

The amendment also introduces a safeguard for drivers. Every vehicle covered by the rule must have an audiovisual alert inside the cabin that will warn the driver if the load cover is open or has not been properly secured while the vehicle is in motion.

The ministry has clarified that the equipment installed to cover the load body will not be counted while measuring the overall height of the vehicle, subject to the provisions of the rules.

The amendment follows a draft notification issued on March 20, 2026, which was published in the Gazette on March 27 for public consultation. MoRTH said it invited objections and suggestions from stakeholders and considered the responses before finalising the amendment.

Although the amendment came into force with its publication in the Official Gazette, vehicle manufacturers and operators have until April 1, 2027, to comply with the new requirement. The measure is expected to reduce the risk of debris falling from moving vehicles, limit dust and waste from escaping into the surroundings, and make road travel cleaner and safer for commuters.

Govt approves

alongside existing paper currency if the trials are successful. The RBI has begun the procurement process, but it is still at an early stage. “At this point of time, it would not be possible to practically determine the exact timeframe for introduction of polymer banknotes or the expenditure likely to be incurred thereon,” she said.

MPOST

‘Vande Mataram’

intentionally preventing or disrupting the singing of the national song will now attract the same penalties as similar offences involving the national anthem. The Lok Sabha passed the Bill on July 30, a day after it was cleared by the Rajya Sabha. Under the amended law, offenders can face up to three years’ imprisonment, a fine, or both, while repeat offenders will receive a minimum one-year jail term.

The Bill noted that there was no specific legal provision earlier to prevent insults to the singing of ‘Vande Mataram’. It cited Constituent Assembly President Dr Rajendra Prasad’s statement of January 24, 1950, that the song composed by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee should enjoy equal status with the national anthem.

The Union Home Ministry also announced that, for the first time, ‘Vande Mataram’ will be sung from the Red Fort on Independence Day. Earlier this year, it issued protocols requiring all six stanzas to be sung first whenever both the national song and anthem are performed together.

MPOST

NASA

astronauts through a series of crewed and uncrewed missions while advancing scientific research and preparing for future deep space exploration.

The invitation was announced in a joint statement after the ninth India-US Civil Space Joint Working Group meeting, held at ISRO headquarters in Bengaluru on August 5 and 6. It said NASA invited ISRO to participate “building on the two countries’ partnership under the Artemis Accords”.

Both sides agreed to advance talks on open scientific data sharing under the accords and expand cooperation following last year’s successful NASA-ISRO NISAR mission. They also discussed future science and human spaceflight technology projects and reaffirmed support for UN guidelines on the long-term sustainability of outer space activities under the TRUST initiative.

MPOST

Briefs

Eminent scientist passes away

THRISSUR: Eminent nuclear scientist, prolific writer and Left theorist M P Parameswaran, known for his pioneering role in popularising science and his controversial “Fourth World” theory, died at his residence here on Tuesday.

Parameswaran (91), a multifaceted personality who worked as a scientist, science communicator, author, theoretician and literacy campaigner, was among the founding figures of the Kerala Sasthra Sahithya Parishad (KSSP), which played a major role in promoting scientific awareness among the masses.

Accused in Rs 2676-cr fraud held

JAIPUR: The Enforcement Directorate has arrested Subhash Chandra Bijnoriya alias Subhash Chandra Bijarniya in the Rs 2,676-crore Nexa Evergreen investment fraud case. Arrested under PMLA on August 10, he was remanded to four-day ED custody. The agency alleged Bijnoriya and associates collected funds by promising assured returns and plot allotment in Dholera Smart City in Gujarat. ED searches earlier recovered Rs 2.04 crore cash while Rs 15 crore in bank accounts and crypto wallets of Nexa Group entities and associated persons were attached.

U’khand acts after bridge road caves...

DEHRADUN: Uttarakhand government issued a show-cause notice to the design consultant of the Nanda Ki Chowki bridge over the Tons River after its approach road caved in within 16 days of its inauguration, officials said. The design consultant, Design Tech Structural Consultant, has 15 days to submit an explanation regarding deficiencies found in the bridge’s design during the preliminary probe. If their reply is unsatisfactory, action will be taken against them, they added.

BKS: National security dialogue concludes

NEW DELHI: Bharat Ki Soch concluded its two-day National Security Dialogue, Mantrana: The Sadgunyam Doctrine, at the India International Centre, bringing together military leaders, diplomats, intelligence experts and strategic scholars. The dialogue explored Kautilya’s six measures of foreign policy and their relevance to contemporary statecraft.

SCHOOLS, BUSINESSES REMAIN CLOSED IN SEVERAL CITIES

J’khand: Bandh over police action on ‘job aspirants’ hits normal life

MPOST BUREAU
Ranchi, August 11

Normal life was affected in parts of Jharkhand on Tuesday as BJP workers blocked roads and burnt tyres during a state-wide bandh in protest against police action on job aspirants who held a march to the state Assembly a day ago over alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations.

Most schools and business establishments remained closed, while vehicular movement was very low in the state capital Ranchi and several other cities. The shutdown, announced after the police used water cannons, tear gas shells and batons against protesters in Ranchi on Monday, was observed from 8 am to midnight, with essential services kept outside its purview, BJP state president Aditya Sahu said.

BJP workers blocked roads in Kishorganj, Argora and Kanke areas in Ranchi, the police said.

They also burnt tyres at Harmu Chowk and Kishorganj Chowk, a senior officer said.

In support of the bandh, Sahu held a protest in Ranchi’s Ratu Road area and termed the JMM-led ruling alliance as “shameless”.

“The JMM and Congress legislators should resign



Security personnel try to stop ABVP and BJP workers as they march towards the Assembly complex, during the ‘Jharkhand Bandh’, in Ranchi, on Tuesday

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The shutdown was observed from 8 am to midnight
- » BJP workers blocked roads in Kishorganj, Argora and Kanke areas in Ranchi on Tuesday
- » The BJP described the Monday’s police action as ‘atrocities’ against students
- » The BJP accused the JMM-led government of using force instead of addressing their grievances

on moral grounds after the police baton-charged protesting students on Monday,” the BJP leader said.

The Congress should show some courage and demand a CBI probe into the recruitment exam

“irregularities”, he said.

“I appeal to all citizens of the state to hit the streets in support of the protesting students as their jobs have been sold,” Sahu said.

He dared Congress

leader Rahul Gandhi to come to Jharkhand, stage a sit-in outside the CM’s residence and force him to order a CBI probe.

Accusing the government of playing with students’ future, the BJP leader said the bandh would be historic.

Ranchi Traffic SP Rakesh Singh said forces have been deployed at all strategic points. “At present, there is no traffic jam or road blockade anywhere in the city. Everything is running normally. Some people are trying to stop vehicles here, but as you can see, road traffic is moving. The police

are making every effort to keep the situation normal.”

The BJP described the police action as “atrocities” against students and accused the JMM-led government of using force instead of addressing their grievances. It backed the protesters’ demand for an independent probe into the alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) and Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC).

Meanwhile, the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), which strongly condemned the alleged police atrocities on students, took out a ‘Vidhan Sabha March’.

The RSS-affiliated student organisation held the procession from the old Vidhan Sabha to the new assembly premises.

The bandh followed a tense day in Ranchi during which thousands of job aspirants marched towards the assembly, breached multiple barricades and clashed with the police.

Several protesters claimed they were injured, while Ranchi police said 14 personnel suffered injuries during the protest. The police had used water cannons near Jagannathpur Temple and fired tear gas shells as protesters moved towards the Assembly.

US partnership with India vital to global security: Sergio Gor

American Ambassador makes remarks after talks with Doval

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 11

The US partnership with India is vital to addressing global security challenges, American Ambassador Sergio Gor said on Tuesday following “fruitful” talks with National Security Advisor Ajit Doval.

Gor said both sides share many of the same goals and the engagement continues to grow.

The US envoy’s meeting with Doval came a day after his talks with Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri.

“Had a fruitful meeting with National Security Advisor Ajit Doval to discuss deepening US-India strategic cooperation,” Gor said on social media.

“Our close partnership with India is vital to addressing global security challenges. The United States and India share many of the same goals and our engagement continues to grow,” he said.

No details of the talks have been shared by the Indian side. Gor’s meeting with Misri and Doval came days after US Vice President JD Vance dialled Prime Minister Narendra Modi to discuss expanding the India-US comprehensive global strategic ties – especially in trade, defence, and energy security – amid rising tensions



in West Asia. This surge in high-level diplomacy follows a recent mutual defence pact signed by Turkiye, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan, a move widely seen as a reflection of a new regional alignment.

However, it is not immediately known whether the defence pact figured in the talks between India and the US. It is learnt that bolstering cooperation in defence, trade and critical minerals figured prominently in the meetings.

Modi and US President Donald Trump, during their meeting in France in June, instructed their officials to work towards a balanced, mutually beneficial and commercially meaningful trade agreement at the earliest.

The relations witnessed a major downturn after Washington imposed punitive tariffs on India last year and President Trump made assertions regarding his role in de-escalating the India-Pakistan military clashes of May 2025 that drew sharp reaction from Indian officials.

Interviews for full-time Ram Temple CEO begin

B P SINGH
Ayodhya, August 11

The selection process for the first full-time Chief Executive Officer of the Shri Ram Jannabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust entered its final stage on Tuesday, with interviews of 18 shortlisted candidates beginning at the Ram temple complex.

A three-member panel is conducting one-on-one interviews on August 11 and 12. It will recommend three names to the Trust, which is expected to take the final decision at its September 2 meeting.

The Trust received more than 5,200 applications after inviting applications in July. Following nearly 20 days of scrutiny, 18 candidates were shortlisted, including retired bureaucrats, former corporate executives, defence officials and those experienced in managing temples and religious trusts.

The selection panel comprises retired Supreme Court judge Justice Pramod Kohli, retired Lieutenant General Vishnukant Chaturvedi and retired nuclear scientist Suresh Haware, former chairperson of the Shri Saibaba Sansthan Trust in Shirdi.

Candidates must be Indian citizens, practising Hindus, graduates aged 50-70 and have at least 20 years of administrative, financial or management experience. Fluency in Hindi and English is mandatory. The selected CEO will have to reside in Ayodhya and follow specified religious requirements.

The CEO will initially serve a three-year term and oversee the temple’s administrative, financial and operational affairs.

The recruitment assumes significance amid an ongoing probe into alleged embezzlement of temple donations.

MP: Six children die, 101 fall ill in Balaghat villages

Balaghat August 11

At least six children have died and 101 others fallen ill in four Baiga tribal villages in Madhya Pradesh’s Balaghat district over the past month, officials said on Tuesday.

“The children died of multiple infections. Blood samples have been sent to the ICMR-National Institute of Research in Bacterial Infections, Kolkata, and the ICMR-National Institute of Virology, Pune to ascertain the exact cause,” Hindustan Times quoted Paresh Upalap, chief medical health officer (CMHO), Balaghat, as saying. Children aged one to 13 in Adori, Kundeksa, Bondari and Korka have reported fever, rashes, red spots, stomach pain and ulcers. Forty-seven children are hospitalised, while 54 are being treated at home. Camps have been set up in affected villages. AGENCIES

SC asks states, UTs to declare cancer a ‘notifiable disease’

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 11

The Supreme Court on Tuesday asked the 19 remaining states and Union territories to declare cancer a “notifiable disease” to ensure early detection and proper care of patients.

The top court’s direction came after it was informed that 17 of the 36 states and UTs have so far notified cancer as a “notified disease” in light of the recommendations made in a parliamentary standing committee report.

The court had, on December 12 last year, issued notices and sought responses from the Centre and all the states and UTs on a public interest litigation (PIL) matter filed by renowned doctor Anurag Srivastava, seeking a direction to declare cancer a “notifiable disease” across the country to ensure early detection and proper care

IT ASKED THE CENTRE AS TO WHY IT IS NOT ISSUING ‘SOME MANDATORY GUIDELINES FOR ALL STATES/UTS’

of patients. On Tuesday, a bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justices Joyimalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked the Centre as to why it is not issuing “some mandatory guidelines for all states/UTs”, saying there should be uniform policy.

Additional Solicitor General Anil Kaushik, appearing in the court for the Centre, said health is a state subject. “Moreover, 17 states have notified the disease,” the law officer said.

“We direct remaining states/UTs to consider the above-stated recommendations and take appropriate decisions. Compliance affidavits have to be filed,”

the CJI said. In his plea, Srivastava has highlighted the failure on the part of the Union health ministry and the states to declare cancer a notifiable disease across India. “Issue an appropriate writ ... nature of mandamus against the Respondent No.1 (Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare) to notify cancer as a notified disease for ensuring uniform and mandatory reporting of cancer cases in India,” the plea says.

“The continued non-notification of cancer, despite its alarming and escalating burden in India, amounts to a grave abdication of the State’s constitutional duty under Articles 14 and 21 of the Constitution, as it denies uniform treatment to similarly-situated citizens and undermines their fundamental right to health and a life with dignity,” it has said.

RCF Kapurthala set to roll out 19-coach rake for B’desh Rly



MPOST BUREAU
Kapurthala, August 11

Rail Coach Factory (RCF), Kapurthala, will roll out its first rake of 19 LHB broad-gauge passenger coaches for Bangladesh Railway on August 12, officials said on Tuesday.

The rake comprises three AC sleeper cars, three AC chair cars, 11 non-AC chair cars and two power cars.

Specially customised for Bangladesh, the coaches feature reclining seats, CCTV surveillance, passenger alarms, partially openable windows, Baby Care and Prayer Rooms. Their roofs have been strengthened for additional loading.

The coaches also incorporate crashworthy provisions conforming to European Standard EN 15227, requiring redesign of the car body shell to improve collision safety.

The electrical system has been designed for 415-volt operation, instead of the conventional 750-volt system used in Indian Railways coaches.

The association between RCF and Bangladesh Railway began with the successful supply of 120 LHB broad gauge passenger coaches during 2015-16.

‘Climate change fuels extreme weather events’

Human factors adding to risk in Himalayas, Centre informs Lok Sabha

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 11

Climate change is aggravating the intensity and frequency of extreme rainfall events in the Himalayan region, while human-related factors are also adding to the disaster risk, the Centre informed Lok Sabha on Tuesday.

The response came to a query on whether climate change and unscientific construction activities were contributing to the rise in cloudbursts incidents and other disasters in Himachal Pradesh.

Minister of State for



A flood-affected woman carries relief supplies through a muddy road as residents navigate waterlogged surroundings, in Sivasagar district, Assam, Aug. 5

Home Affairs Nityanand Rai said assessments by

weather experts, scientific institutions and

KEY POINTS

- » Assessments indicate that climate change has increased the intensity and frequency of extreme rainfall events in the Himalayan region’
- » The govt has constituted a Multi-Sectoral Central Team in view of the increasing frequency of cloudbursts, flash floods, landslides and extreme rainfall events in HP

state authorities indicate that climate change has

increased the intensity and frequency of extreme rainfall events in the Himalayan region.

The government has constituted a Multi-Sectoral Central Team (MSCT) in view of the increasing frequency and intensity of cloudbursts, flash floods, landslides and extreme rainfall events in Himachal Pradesh, the minister said.

The team comprises experts from the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA), Central Building Research Institute (CBRI), Roorkee, Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune,

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Indore, and various concerned agencies.

Inputs from the India Meteorological Department (IMD), Central Water Commission (CWC) and Geological Survey of India (GSI) have also been incorporated.

The MSCT has been tasked with scientific assessment of the causes of increasing extreme weather events in the state, including studying geographical and ground conditions of worst-affected areas and examining data received from various agencies.

EDITORIAL

Citizenship Decree

The Trump administration's renewed attempt to narrow birthright citizenship in the United States brings an old constitutional dispute back into focus. Two new executive orders seek to restrict automatic citizenship for additional categories of children born on American soil, including those connected to foreign governments and international organisations, and births resulting from what the administration describes as "birth tourism". The measures follow an earlier legal setback for President Donald Trump and have been framed by the White House as more carefully tailored to withstand judicial scrutiny. Yet narrowing an executive order does not resolve the central constitutional question: how far can a president go in deciding who qualifies for citizenship when the Constitution itself establishes the governing principle?

The 14th Amendment has long provided the foundation of American birthright citizenship, granting citizenship to persons born or naturalised in the United States and subject to its jurisdiction. Existing law already recognises limited exceptions, most notably children born to accredited foreign diplomats. The administration now wants to expand those exclusions. Tougher scrutiny of visa applicants travelling primarily to give birth falls within the government's immigration powers. Misrepresenting the purpose of travel can already have immigration consequences. But preventing entry is legally different from denying citizenship to a child once born in the United States.

That distinction becomes more important when the orders move into less settled territory. Questions surrounding surrogacy, employees of international organisations and parents allegedly connected with organisations treated as security threats raise issues of definition and due process. Determining a newborn's constitutional status according to allegations concerning a parent could create administrative uncertainty. Citizenship cannot depend on vague classifications or inconsistent decisions by officials.

The administration has a legitimate interest in combating immigration fraud and commercial operations that coach travellers to deceive consular or border officials. If businesses facilitate fraudulent visa applications for women seeking to give birth in the United States, existing laws should be enforced. But policy must also be proportionate to evidence. The administration's claim that birth tourism involves "hundreds of thousands" of cases appears difficult to reconcile with the more limited estimates cited by researchers. Exaggerating the scale risks turning an enforcement issue into justification for a broader constitutional intervention.

Ultimately, the latest orders are likely to return the argument to the courts. The larger issue extends beyond immigration politics or the merits of birthright citizenship itself. Constitutional guarantees are deliberately difficult to alter because they are meant to survive changing governments and political priorities. A president may tighten visa procedures, combat fraud and enforce immigration laws within statutory authority. Reinterpreting the boundaries of citizenship by executive action is another matter. If Americans believe the constitutional understanding of birthright citizenship should change, that debate belongs within constitutional and legislative processes. Citizenship is too fundamental a right to have its meaning repeatedly rewritten from the White House.

LETTER



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Uneasy Neighbours

India is right to emphasise that peace along the LAC is essential for stable ties with China. Diplomatic engagement must continue, but without compromising territorial integrity. China's attempts to rename places in Arunachal Pradesh cannot alter established realities. Mutual trust requires respect for borders, agreements and each other's sovereignty.

JOHN D'SOUZA,
ARUNACHAL PRADESH

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Justice Beyond Compliance

Shikhandi's story reveals how rigid principles, unheard grievances and unresolved injustice can shape destinies, challenging leaders to balance rules with responsibility and compassion

BHARAT KI SOCH

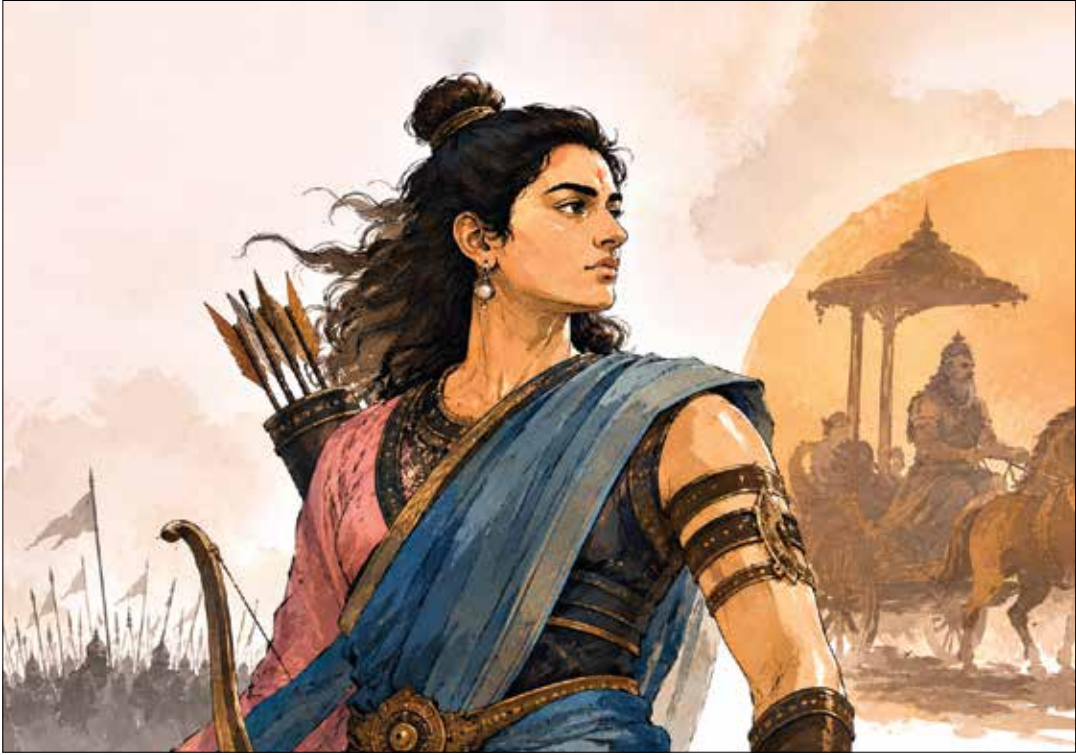


ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE
CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

What happens when a person keeps every rule and still leaves another life in ruins? This is the difficult question at the heart of Shikhandi's story. Long before Kurukshetra, Bhishma went to the swayamvara of the three princesses of Kashi and carried them away for his younger half-brother, Vichitravirya. Amba, the eldest, then told Bhishma the truth: she had already chosen Shalva and intended to marry him. Bhishma allowed her to leave, but Shalva rejected her. When Amba returned, she expressed her desire to marry Bhishma, believing that he now bore responsibility for the situation in which she had been placed. Bhishma, however, could not accept her because of his life-long vow of celibacy. Each man had reasons for his decision, yet it was Amba who was left to bear the consequences.

Amba's willingness to speak the truth is itself significant. She did not conceal her commitment to Shalva, even though revealing it complicated the situation before her. Yet speaking the truth is meaningful only when those with the ability to act are prepared to hear and respond to it. This carries an important lesson for institutions as well. Leaders must create an environment where difficult truths can be raised early, because con-



Leaders must have the courage to correct what their decisions have damaged

cerns that are heard in time are often easier to address than consequences that are allowed to deepen.

Bhishma's position should not be judged too simply. His vow embodied extraordinary sacrifice, discipline and loyalty, and it had shaped the course of his life. Yet Amba's suffering exposes a difficult distinction between adherence to principle and the fuller demands of justice. Through the lens of Niti and Dharma, we can see that Niti may provide rules, order and a framework for conduct, while Dharma asks the deeper question of what is right in the circumstances and who must bear the consequence. Principles do not absolve us from responsibility for the consequences they create. A vow may explain why Bhishma could not marry Amba, but explanation alone could not restore what she had lost.

The same distinction matters in corporate life. Policies, contracts and procedures create consistency and protect institutions from arbitrary decisions, but conformity to a rule cannot be the end of leadership responsibility. A decision may satisfy

RULES PROVIDE ORDER, BUT RESPONSIBLE LEADERSHIP REQUIRES JUDGEMENT, EMPATHY AND A WILLINGNESS TO EXAMINE WHETHER THE OUTCOME WAS FAIR

policy and still damage trust, dignity or fairness. Good leadership does not merely explain why harm occurred or why mistakes were made. It takes responsibility and makes an honest effort to set things right. Rules provide order, but responsible leadership requires judgement, empathy and the willingness to examine whether the outcome was truly fair.

Amba refused to let her grievance disappear into silence. After repeated attempts to obtain redress, her pain hardened into determination. The epic recounts that she was reborn as Shikhan-

dini, the child of King Drupada. Though born female, Shikhandini was raised as a son, and later, through an exchange with the Yaksha Sthuna, acquired a male body and lived as Shikhandi. Dignity begins with refusing to let rejection, exclusion or circumstance define one's potential. Shikhandi's life represents persistence in the face of judgements that might otherwise have confined an entire future.

The episode also raises a deeper question about identity and social recognition. Bhishma continued to see Shikhandi through the memory of an earlier female birth, even though Shikhandi stood before him as a trained warrior. The story should not be reduced to labels alone. Human worth cannot be determined by labels or by society's first judgement of who a person is. Families, organisations and institutions often inherit assumptions about who belongs, who is capable and who should occupy certain roles. Ethical conduct asks us to look beyond those assumptions and judge people through their character, ability and actions.

Yet Amba's story also con-

tains a warning. Her anger arose from genuine injustice, but her existence became increasingly centred on Bhishma's downfall. Pain can give us strength and purpose, but it should not become the sole author of our identity. Remembering injustice can inspire courage and the pursuit of accountability, but if every future choice is organised around an old wound, the past continues to exercise power over the present. Justice should ultimately create the possibility of freedom, not another form of captivity.

On the tenth day of the Kurukshetra war, Shikhandi confronted Bhishma. Bhishma would not strike him, while Shikhandi continued to shoot arrows at him. Arjuna urged Shikhandi forward and then used the opening to release the decisive shower of arrows that brought Bhishma down. Shikhandi was therefore not merely a shield. His presence changed the conditions of the battle, and he actively participated in it. What had begun as Amba's unheard grievance had returned with consequences far beyond the original wrong. An unheard grievance does not simply disappear. Left unresolved, it can become an institutional risk. In corporate life, legitimate hurt that is ignored may return as mistrust, disengagement, resistance or fracture.

Shikhandi's story is therefore far more than one of revenge. Amba reminds us that injustice cannot be extinguished by explanation, procedure or silence. Shikhandi teaches persistence and the refusal to remain imprisoned by society's judgement. Bhishma teaches that even honourable vows can produce unjust consequences when compassion and responsibility are absent. Dharma is not merely the keeping of one's word. It requires us to ask whether justice was served, dignity was protected and consequences were acknowledged and addressed. Leaders must have the courage to correct what their decisions have damaged, because ignored grievances rarely disappear. They often return through the consequences they create.

Views expressed are personal

AI's Use of Copyright Material

AI's growing appetite for copyrighted content is forcing courts to redefine fair use, ownership and compensation

CREATIVE RIGHTS



LATHA JISHNU

THE WRITER IS AN
INDEPENDENT JOURNALIST

July was packed with cases pivoting on the legality of artificial intelligence (AI) companies helping themselves to data across the world to train their large language models. The lawsuits involved the critical issue of copyright protection, in particular for publishing companies and a range of creative fields such as literature, cinema and music, as AI behemoths such as OpenAI, Google, Anthropic and Meta freely mine data to train their machines. Is it copyright infringement, as courts in Europe have held, or fair use, as US courts have ruled? The Delhi High Court also

weighed in on this critical question in a case filed by news agency ANI (Asian News International) against OpenAI and said in a preliminary ruling that the AI entity's use of copyright material did not constitute infringement but was fair use, or "fair dealing" under India's copyright law.

The copyright law and its interpretation here and in the US and the UK in relation to AI are fluid, unlike in the EU, which has a clearly defined AI Act brought in 2024. This codifies new requirements for AI model training under the copyright law and stipulates that reproductions made for AI training must be authorised by rights holders, unless covered by existing copyright exceptions such as text and data mining (TDM) provisions.

Thus, a regional court in Munich had no difficulty in ruling against OpenAI in a case filed by German music copyright organisation GEMA. It stated that the use of copyrighted song lyrics for training generative AI models without a licence violated German copyright law. The court rejected OpenAI's untenable argument that users, and not the platform, were responsible for any infringement.

Towards the end of July, a US federal judge gave final approval to a record US \$1.5 billion class action settlement in a suit filed in 2024 by a large group of authors against Anthropic over the misuse of their books to train its AI



AS PUBLISHERS, AUTHORS AND MUSICIANS CHALLENGE AI COMPANIES, COURTS MUST DECIDE WHERE TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION ENDS AND COPYRIGHT INFRINGEMENT BEGINS

chatbot, Claude. They accused Anthropic of retaining and storing their works, totalling nearly half a million pirated books, without authorisation and sued for damages. The court said that AI model training could copy the books without being liable for copyright infringement, but storing pirated, shadow-library text

exposed the company to legal challenges.

The confrontation of rights-holders with AI companies over intellectual property rights, which started in 2024, is intensifying. In May, a group of publishers joined forces to take on Meta and its head Mark Zuckerberg over the unauthorised

use of their copyrighted books and academic materials to train Llama, the company's LLM. Meta has rejected the allegations, maintaining that AI training qualifies as fair use under US copyright law.

Refusing ANI's plea for an interim injunction, Justice Amit Bansal said that using copyrighted material to train LLMs falls within the fair dealing exemption for research under the Copyright Act, 1957.

ANI had filed a lawsuit against OpenAI in the Delhi High Court in November 2024, alleging that the US-based company used its published content, some of it behind paywalls, without permission to train its AI models and that ChatGPT attributed fabricated stories to the news agency.

A number of stakeholders, including the Digital News Publishers Association, the Indian Music Industry, the Federation of Indian Publishers, and technology-based start-ups have filed interventions in this suit, turning the case into a major policy question on what can be termed fair use by the AI industry. The outcome will have implications for every creative field from cinema to music, for every publisher and for the future of media since AI systems train on their output without consent or compensation, and then build a commercial product to compete against them.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Drone strike sparks massive blaze at Libya refinery

CAIRO: Firefighters in western Libya fought Tuesday to extinguish the remnants of a massive fire caused by a drone strike on an oil facility, and a car bomb killed a senior military officer in the country's east, in the latest attacks in the chaos-stricken North African nation.

The drone hit a gasoline tank at the Zawiya oil refinery in the Mediterranean town of Zawiya on Monday, about 47 kilometers (about 30 miles) west of capital Tripoli, the state-run National Oil Corporation said.

Lebanon abolishes death penalty in parliament vote

BEIRUT: Lebanon's parliament Tuesday abolished the death penalty, making it the first country in the Arab world to replace the sentencing with life imprisonment with aggravated hard labour.

The tiny Mediterranean country has committed to an unofficial moratorium on executions since January 2004. However, dozens of death sentences since then have been issued, but later suspended or commuted. A majority of Lebanon's 128-member parliament voted in favour of ending the death penalty.

Iran-backed Houthi rebels renew attacks in Yemen

DUBAI: Iranian-backed Houthi rebels renewed their attacks Tuesday on government-controlled areas in Yemen as ongoing violence threatened to reignite the country's civil war and raised fears over new threats to shipping lanes.

Iran's foreign minister, meanwhile, underscored Tehran's stance against reopening the Strait until the US meets its conditions, in comments that came after US President Donald Trump said he was now demanding compensation from Iran "for all of the people that they have killed" in the past.



Women from Pakistan's Hindu community take part in rally to mark the National Minorities Day, in Karachi on Friday

AP/PTI

Briefs

Russian attacks kill 10 in Ukraine

KYIV: Russia attacked Ukrainian cities with missiles, drones and glide bombs Tuesday, killing at least 10 civilians, officials said, as President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Moscow is getting new military help from North Korea. Zelenskyy said Russian forces used ballistic missiles supplied by North Korea in an overnight attack on the southeastern city of Zaporizhzhia, where officials said 7 people were killed.

PML-N set to form govt in PoK

ISLAMABAD: A Two former so-called prime ministers suffered defeats in their strongholds in the third phase of elections in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, according to unofficial results released on Tuesday. Pakistan People's Party's Faisal Mumtaz Rathore, who is currently serving as the region's premier, managed to retain his seat in the polls, marred by violence and allegations of rigging.

Beijing steps up flood response

BEIJING: Beijing stepped up its flood-control response on Tuesday as authorities issued red rainstorm alerts in several districts in the Chinese capital and warned of heavy downpours, with heightened risks of urban waterlogging and landslides.

The Beijing meteorological service issued an orange rainstorm alert.

3 militants killed in Pakistan

PESHAWAR: Two militants were killed by security forces on Tuesday in an intelligence-based operation in northwest Pakistan, police said. The incident occurred near Adnan cricket stadium in the Jani Khel area of the Bannu district in the restive Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province. The slain militants, identified as Zakir and Umar Khattab, were residents of Lakki Marwat district. A search operation was underway.

AT LEAST 179 PEOPLE KILLED IN LARGEST EARTHQUAKE IN YEARS

Over 3,000 missing as search efforts resume after devastating earthquake

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Newcastle, August 11

Search and rescue efforts resumed on Tuesday in dozens of cities and towns in western Colombia after a Monday's 7.4 magnitude earthquake left over 3,000 missing, with many trapped under the debris.

Mayors and governors from Cali, Pereira, Choco and Manizalez said on Tuesday at least 179 people had died in those four areas; the federal government, which last updated its estimates Monday, has said at least 111 died.

Around 1,600 buildings were reported damaged or collapsed. Soldiers, rescue personnel and families picked through the rubble, passing large pieces of concrete by hand along lines of volunteers.

Choco, the region surrounding the quake's epicentre, is one of Colombia's poorest and most neglected regions, often beset by warring armed groups. Much of Choco is accessible only by boat, through the jungle or by airplane. Little was known about the extent of damage there. The country's new president, Abelardo De la Espriella, travelled to Choco's capital, Quibdo, on Monday night and



Residents and rescue workers search through the rubble after an earthquake struck Cali on Monday

AP/PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Around 1,600 buildings were reported damaged or collapsed
- » Soldiers, rescue personnel and families picked through the rubble

announced he had mobilised "the entire military and police apparatus" to respond, deploying engineers, rescue workers and search dogs. "Choco will

never again be the land of the forgotten," he said.

The earthquake presents the first major test for de la Espriella, who was sworn in on Friday. De la Espriella has been a divisive figure because of his pledge of an all-out crack-down on criminal groups in the Andean nation.

Families posted infor-

mation about missing loved ones on citizen-run websites.

Dana Carolina Zamora posted an image of her missing 60-year-old uncle, Miguel Angel Zamora, cradling his dog. The farmer was living in a rural area of El Cairo, not far from the quake's epicentre in San Jose Del Palmar.

Former Syrian President Assad sentenced to death in absentia

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Damascus, August 11

A Syrian court sentenced ousted Syrian President Bashar Assad along with his younger brother to death in absentia on Tuesday for crimes against humanity and war crimes during Syria's conflict that left about half a million people dead.

The sentences at the Fourth Criminal Court in Damascus are the first against Assad or members

BASHAR ASSAD USED STATE AGENCIES TO COMMIT WAR CRIMES AND CRIMES AGAINST HUMANITY

of his inner circle since the Assad family's five decades in power came to an end 20 months ago.

"Bashar Assad used state agencies to commit war crimes and crimes against

humanity," said judge Fakhareddine al-Aryan during a court session. Also sentenced to death was Assad's maternal cousin Atef Najib, who was convicted of overseeing a crackdown in the southern province of Daraa that led to the uprising and later the civil war. Al-Aryan said Najib can appeal.

Under tight security, Najib stood inside a cage wearing a prisoner's uniform as the judge read the sentence.

Congo Ebola death toll crosses 2,000

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Bunia, August 11

At least 2,000 people have died in Congo's Ebola outbreak, the fastest-growing on record, according to the latest data, as health authorities struggle to get help to remote localities due to rebel conflict, bad roads and work stoppages over payment issues.

Government data published overnight into Tuesday showed the outbreak has recorded a total of 4,381 confirmed cases,



Representational Image

including 2,011 deaths. Starting from the first con-

firmed case, that death toll was reached almost three

times faster than in the 2014-16 Ebola outbreak, the worst on record.

The current outbreak was declared on May 15 but health authorities say sequencing showed it began months earlier, in February.

While it took about nine weeks for the outbreak to record the first 1,000 deaths, it's taken just around three weeks for the figure to double, an evidence that the health crisis is moving faster than efforts to track and manage it.

‘England on track to eliminate Hepatitis C virus’

The health service administered treatment involves a free course of antiviral tablets

ASSOCIATED PRESS

London, August 11

England is on track to be one of the first countries in the world to eliminate the Hepatitis C virus after a decade-long programme to administer life-saving treatment, the National Health Service (NHS) said on Tuesday.

NHS England said that since the roll-out of pioneering antiviral drugs in 2015, over 100,000 people have been diagnosed and treated for Hep C. The state-funded



health service administered treatment involves a free course of antiviral tablets lasting eight to 12 weeks, which it claims cures more than 95 per cent of cases.

"We are making significant prog-

KEY POINTS

- » Over 100,000 people have been diagnosed and treated for Hepatitis C
- » The NHS reinforced a drive this week urging those at greater risk of having undiagnosed Hepatitis C

ress towards eliminating Hepatitis C as a public health threat," said Dr Sema Mandal, Deputy Director - Blood Safety, Hepatitis, STIs and HIV Division at UK Health Security Agency (UKHSA).

"The sharp fall in cases since 2015 shows the impact of expanded testing and sustained access to modern curative treatments, and the commitment of health services and community partners

across England.

"Treating over 100,000 people in just 10 years is a remarkable achievement and brings England closer than ever to becoming one of the first countries in the world to eliminate this disease as a public health threat," she said.

The epidemiologist noted that while the number of people living with the virus continues to decline, it remains vital that those most at risk are offered testing to prevent new infections.

Pak minister Naqvi heads to Iran

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Islamabad, August 11

Pakistan Interior Minister Mohsin Raza Naqvi on Tuesday headed to Tehran for talks with Iranian officials amid mediation efforts to end Iran-US conflict, report said.

IRNA, cited a diplomatic source saying Naqvi departed for the Iranian capital early Tuesday for talks on bilateral ties and issues of mutual interest.

There was no immediate confirmation from

Pakistani or Iranian authorities.

The visit comes a month after Iranian Interior Minister Eskandar Momeni travelled to Islamabad for talks with his Pakistani counterpart.

Pakistan, supported by Gulf countries like Qatar, has been trying to mediate between the US and Iran, but the conflict continues because of a range of factors - the blocking of the Strait of Hormuz being the key reason at this point.

News at a glance

Fitch affirms India rating at BBB- with a stable outlook

NEW DELHI: Fitch Ratings on Tuesday affirmed India's sovereign rating at 'BBB-' with a stable outlook and said the domestic economy remains strong, despite headwinds from the energy shock arising from the West Asia crisis.

Fitch said it does not expect a durable risk to India's growth prospects arising from uncertainty related to the US-Iran conflict.

"India's economy has been resilient to shocks in recent years, a trend we expect to continue," Fitch said, while assigning the lowest investment grade rating of 'BBB-'.

Trade disputes: Govt advises against two Bhutanese firms

NEW DELHI: The Commerce Ministry has advised exporters, banks, ECGC and other stakeholders to exercise heightened vigilance while dealing with Bhutan-based Legoy Powersports and Druk A-Z Store due to potential trading risks.

The DGFT issued the advisory following complaints against the two firms and said repeated efforts to verify the matter and resolve it amicably had yielded no substantive response.

Stakeholders have been advised to conduct due diligence, assess transaction risks and report payment issues or disputes to the DGFT.

Vijay Singh steps down from Sir Ratan Tata Trust

MUMBAI: Tata Trusts Vice-Chairman Vijay Singh has stepped down as a trustee of Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) and will not seek renewal when his current term ends on August 14, people familiar with the matter said.

Singh, a former defence secretary, will continue as a trustee of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust. His exit comes amid differences among SRTT trustees, with the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner barring the trust from holding board meetings pending an inquiry. SRTT has sought removal of the restriction ahead of Tata Sons' August 18 AGM.

JSW Dulux posts ₹79.7cr Q1 profit, board clears stock split

NEW DELHI: JSW Dulux Ltd reported a 12.4 per cent decline in consolidated net profit to Rs 79.7 crore for the June quarter of FY27, compared with Rs 91 crore a year ago.

Revenue from operations fell 2.82 per cent to Rs 965 crore, while total expenses declined 0.76 per cent to Rs 872.9 crore.

The company's board approved a 1:10 stock split, subject to shareholder and regulatory approvals. Each Rs 10 equity share will be split into 10 shares of Re 1 each. JSW Paints acquired a 60.76 per cent stake in the company in December 2025.

Briefs

SBI has 5-6 deals to finance M&A

MUMBAI: SBI has five to six M&A financing deals in the pipeline, a senior bank official said on Tuesday.

SBI has already executed three deals under the RBI's acquisition financing framework introduced earlier this year.

Under RBI guidelines, banks can finance up to 75% of an acquisition's value.

Shiprocket raises ₹727 cr from anchors

NEW DELHI: E-commerce enablement platform Shiprocket Ltd on Tuesday secured Rs 727.41 crore from anchor investors ahead of its initial public offering (IPO) on Wednesday.

Investors included New York State Teachers Retirement System, Nomura Funds Ireland, Societe Generale, ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, Tata AIA Life Insurance and Axis Max Life Insurance.

Piccadily Agro posts ₹21.3 cr profit

NEW DELHI: Piccadily Agro Industries posted a 15.35 per cent rise in net profit to Rs 21.30 crore for Q1 FY27, driven by its premium Alcobev portfolio.

Revenue from operations grew 18.12 per cent to Rs 270.50 crore. Distillery revenue rose 26.3 per cent to Rs 205.65 crore, while branded Alcobev revenue jumped 47.3 per cent.

CFO Natwar Aggarwal expects 60-70 per cent growth for FY27.

‘OUT OF 436 APPROVED SEZs, 372 ARE NOTIFIED’

As many as 95 special eco zones are non-operational as on July 31: Govt

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

As many as 277 special economic zones (SEZs) are operational and 95 are non-operational in the country as on July 31 this year, Parliament was informed on Tuesday.

In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Commerce and Industry Jitin Prasada said that 372 such zones, out of 436 approved, are notified.

According to the data provided by the minister, the maximum number of non-operational zones are in Haryana (14).

It was followed by Telangana (12), Karnataka (11), and nine each in Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh.

He said that the time taken in operationalising SEZs could be due to reasons such as time taken for getting approvals from the statutory/state government bodies, adverse business climate due to shifts in the global economic scenario, and changes in fiscal incentives.

He also informed that exports from these zones



ACCORDING TO THE DATA PROVIDED BY MINISTER OF STATE FOR COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY JITIN PRASADA, THE MAXIMUM NUMBER OF NON-OPERATIONAL ZONES ARE IN HARYANA (14)

stood at Rs 16.4 lakh crore in 2025-26, an increase from Rs 14.63 lakh crore in 2024-25. It was Rs 13.55 lakh crore in 2023-24 and Rs 12.63 lakh crore in 2022-23.

Special Economic Zones are set up under the SEZ Act, 2005, and SEZ Rules, 2006. They are primarily private investment-driven initiatives.

A SEZ may be set up either jointly or severally by the central government,

state government or any person for manufacture of goods or rendering services or for both or as a free trade warehousing zone.

In a separate reply, Prasada said India and the US have announced on February 7 that the two countries have reached a framework for an interim agreement regarding reciprocal and mutually beneficial trade.

"Negotiations are ongoing," he said.

KEY POINTS

- » It was followed by Telangana (12), Karnataka (11), and nine each in Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh
- » 'Exports from these zones stood at Rs 16.4 lakh crore in 2025-26, an increase from Rs 14.63 lakh crore in 2024-25. It was Rs 13.55 lakh crore in 2023-24 and Rs 12.63 lakh crore in 2022-23'
- » 'India has signed 17 Free Trade Agreements (FTAs), including comprehensive economic partnership/cooperation agreements, with its trade partners'

signed in the last five years with Mauritius, UAE, Australia, the European Free Trade Association (EFTA), the UK, Oman and New Zealand.

In another reply, he said India is committed to fostering and expanding digital trade partnerships with potential nations across the world.

For instance, trade agreements with the UAE, UK, and the European Union include a dedicated chapter on digital trade with an aim to enhance and facilitate digital trade.

Replying to a separate question, he said the merchandise trade deficit primarily reflects the import requirements of a rapidly growing economy.

A significant share of India's imports comprises crude oil, electronic goods, machinery and capital goods, gold and precious stones, and fertilisers, which are essential for meeting domestic consumption requirements, ensuring energy security, supporting manufacturing, infrastructure development and industrial expansion.

Land reforms, pvt finance are key to scaling affordable housing: Gauba

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) organized a National Conference on Affordable Housing Reforms titled "Reimagining Affordable Housing: From Scheme to Sustainable Ecosystem" on Tuesday, in Vigyan Bhawan, with policymakers, experts, States and UTs and financial institutions discussing reforms to promote and scale affordable housing.

NITI Aayog Member Rajiv Gauba spoke at the event as Chief Guest in the opening session.

"Land is the most binding

constraint in the housing sector and therefore, it has to be at the centre of the reform agenda," Gauba said, suggesting waiver of land-use change fee for land earmarked for affordable housing and stamp duty on affordable housing units to make it more viable. He further recommended catalyzing rental housing as a solution for migrant workers, youth, students as well as industrial workers.

Gauba recommended a focus on private participation and innovation in financing in affordable housing, saying that according to the NITI Aayog-MoHUA report 'A

Comprehensive Framework to Promote Affordable Housing' being discussed at the event, at least 10 per cent of residential land use in master plans should be reserved for affordable housing, with permissible FAR raised to 5 or 6.

"Transit oriented development, land pooling and transferable development rights, relaxing parking and density norms, and creation of land banks can be some of the ways to unlock land resources for more affordable housing," he added. MoHUA Secretary Satendra Singh said that affordable housing is not only a social security

issue, but also an economic growth and employment generator, and a catalyst for sustainable urban development.

The recommendations made at the conference will act as a framework to promote and scale affordable housing, he said, adding that the Ministry looks forward to continued Centre-State cooperation to realize housing for all.

The conference also reviewed progress of PMAY-U and discussed the role of reforms and innovative financing in the proposed PMAY-U 2.0 to cover one crore additional eligible urban housing households.

RBI Guv asks banks to ensure human oversight of AI

‘Responsibility must ultimately rest with banks & not algorithms or tech vendors’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 11

Reserve Bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Tuesday urged banks to maintain "meaningful human oversight" while designing and deploying artificial intelligence (AI) models, saying responsibility for decisions must ultimately rest with banks and not algorithms or technology vendors.

Addressing FIBAC 2026, the annual banking conference organised by FICCI



Reserve Bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra

and the Indian Banks' Association, Malhotra said artificial intelligence should augment rather than merely replace human judgment and urged lenders

CLOSER LOOK

- » 'AI should augment rather than merely replace human judgment and lenders should adopt the technology responsibly'
- » He warned that excessive reliance on artificial intelligence could erode human judgment and accountability
- » Banks must retain ability to override AI-driven decisions, where errors could harm customers or financial stability

to adopt the technology responsibly.

He warned that excessive reliance on AI could erode human judgment and accountability.

Banks must retain the ability to explain, intervene and override AI-driven decisions, particularly where errors could materially harm customers or affect financial stability.

Malhotra also flagged cybersecurity threats, model biases and the risk of "herding" if banks rely on a limited number of AI models or technology vendors.

Such concentration could allow biases to spread across the financial system.

He asked banks to treat data privacy as more than a legal compliance requirement and strengthen risk management when working with external technology partners.

AI systems should also be capable of explaining the rationale behind their recommendations, he said.

He called on banks to maintain a complete inventory of AI models in use and establish board-approved AI governance policies with clear accountability for outcomes. He said meaningful human oversight should remain a core design principle wherever AI-related errors could cause significant harm to customers or pose risks to financial stability.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



NTPC Ltd successfully concluded the national finale of Medha Pratiyogita 2026 at Power Management Institute (PMI), Noida. Winners were Ahaan and Devayansh Singh (Junior, Western Region); Utkarsh Parikh and Darsh Jain (Middle, Northern Region); Tanmay Verma and Harshit Sharma (Senior, Northern Region); and Anshuman Shrivastav and Shubham Mishra (Employee, Western Region). Director (HR) Anil Kumar Jadli presented awards.

News at a glance

Gold soars to two-month high of ₹1.57 lakh/10 grams

NEW DELHI: Gold prices climbed for the sixth straight session, rising Rs 1,200 to a two-month high of Rs 1.57 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, as stronger investment demand by traders kept bullion elevated despite firm oil rates.

The gold of 99.9 per cent purity jumped Rs 1,200 to 1,57,200/10 grams from Monday's closing level of Rs 1,56,000 per 10 grams, according to the All India Sarafa Association. Silver also riding the same wave, jumped Rs 2,000 to Rs 2,42,000/kilogram, taking the white metal to its highest level in over two months.

DPIIT and MSME Ministry ink MoU to boost GI exports

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) and the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) signed an MoU on August 5 at Vanijya Bhawan in New Delhi to accelerate the commercialisation, quality standardisation, and market penetration of India's Geographical Indication products.

The MoU was signed by Md. Salik Parwaiz, Director, Ministry of MSME, and Karan Thapar, Director, IPR Division, DPIIT, in the presence of senior officials from both organisations.

RBI curbs on NBFC Flexi Credit may hike costs: Kotak

NEW DELHI: The RBI's proposed curbs on revolving credit facilities offered by NBFCs could hike operational challenges, reduce lender returns and raise borrowing costs, Kotak Institutional Equities said. Flexi facilities, widely used by MSME borrowers, allow repeated drawdowns and repayments based on cash flows. NBFCs typically earn a 50-100 basis point premium on such loans.

Kotak said the move is likely to shift market share rather than cause significant borrower losses. The RBI has invited comments until August 28.

Vande Bharatam picks 50+ innovators from 26K entries

AHMEDABAD: Vande Bharatam, the grassroots innovation and entrepreneurship initiative launched by Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani, has selected its inaugural cohort of more than 50 innovators from over 26,000 applications received from across the country, the organisers said on Tuesday.

The selected innovators are currently in Ahmedabad for the Vande Bharatam Immersive Week, where they are undergoing mentorship sessions. The nationwide initiative received applications from every state and Union Territory.

Briefs

Rupee falls 6 paise to 95.36/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee declined 6 paise to settle at 95.36 against the US dollar on Tuesday, tracking a sharp rise in global crude oil prices amid geopolitical uncertainties.

At the interbank forex market, the rupee opened at 95.38 against the US dollar & traded in a range of 95.36-95.45. It settled at 95.36, down 6 paise from previous close.

Direct tax mop up rises to ₹8.11L cr

NEW DELHI: Net direct tax collection rose 23.09 per cent to over Rs 8.11 lakh crore till August 10 in the current fiscal, government data showed.

Net corporate tax collection grew 19.83 per cent to Rs 2.70 lakh crore, while non-corporate tax mop-up increased 23 per cent to Rs 5.07 lakh crore. STT revenue jumped 51 per cent to Rs 33,824 crore.

Refunds worth Rs 1.43 lakh crore were issued during the period.

Kharif sowing gap dips to 1.82%

NEW DELHI: Kharif crop sowing lagged 1.82 per cent year-on-year at 967.92 lakh hectare as of August 7, Agriculture Ministry data showed.

Paddy acreage fell 4.40 per cent to 344.78 lakh hectare, while pulses and coarse cereals also declined. Oilseed acreage rose to 180.20 lakh hectare from 175.01 lakh hectare. Sugarcane and cotton acreage remained broadly unchanged, while jute/mesta increased.

SIP INFLOWS REMAIN ABOVE ₹31K CR FOR 5 MONTHS IN ROW
Equity Mutual Fund investments decline 15% to ₹24,697 crore in July

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 11

Equity mutual fund inflows fell 15 per cent month-on-month to Rs 24,697 crore in July, as investors turned more selective amid concerns over valuations and muted equity returns, though sustained SIP contributions continued to provide strong support to the segment.

Despite the decline, equity-oriented schemes recorded their 65th consecutive month of positive inflows in July, according to data released by industry body Amfi on Tuesday.

However, the inflow was sharply lower than Rs 28,973 crore in June and Rs 42,702 crore in July last year. The moderation comes despite continued retail participation, with monthly Systematic Investment Plan (SIP) contributions rising marginally to Rs 31,961 crore in July, from Rs 31,781 crore in June.

SIP inflows have remained above Rs 31,000 crore for five consecutive months. The data



DESPITE THE DECLINE, EQUITY-ORIENTED SCHEMES RECORDED THEIR 65TH CONSECUTIVE MONTH OF POSITIVE INFLOWS IN JULY, ACCORDING TO DATA RELEASED BY AMFI

KEY POINTS

- » However, the inflow was sharply lower than Rs 28,973 crore in June and Rs 42,702 crore in July last year
- » The moderation comes despite continued retail participation, with monthly SIP contributions rising marginally to Rs 31,961 crore in July, from Rs 31,781 crore in June
- » Smallcap funds attracted Rs 7,768 cr in July, followed by midcap funds with Rs 6,192 cr, flexicap funds with Rs 4,710 cr and Largecap funds received Rs 1,322 cr

points to a more cautious approach among investors, with money continuing to enter equities but at a slower pace and with greater selectivity.

"The moderation in equity mutual fund inflows reflects a degree of selectivity rather than a loss of investor confidence in equities. It also highlights ongoing portfolio rebalancing amid evolving val-

uations, with investors favouring segments that offer stronger long-term return potential while remaining mindful of associated risks," said Ankur Punj, MD & Business Head, Equirus Wealth.

Akhil Chaturvedi, Executive Director and Chief Business Officer, Motilal Oswal Asset Management Company, said the cautious stance towards

equity-oriented mutual funds was partly due to lower returns over the past two years.

Among equity categories, smallcap funds led the inflows, attracting Rs 7,768 crore in July, followed by midcap funds with Rs 6,192 crore and flexicap funds with Rs 4,710 crore. Large-cap funds received Rs 1,322 crore during the month.

"July's mutual fund flow data is broadly in line with expectations, with investor interest in diversified equity categories remaining steady," said Santosh Joseph, CEO, Germinate Investor Services.

The broader mutual fund industry, however, witnessed a turnaround in July, recording a net inflow of around Rs 2.36 lakh crore, compared with a net outflow of Rs 52,949 crore in June.

The reversal was driven by debt-oriented schemes, which attracted around Rs 1.88 lakh crore in July, reversing the Rs 1.09 lakh crore outflow recorded in June. Liquid funds emerged as the biggest

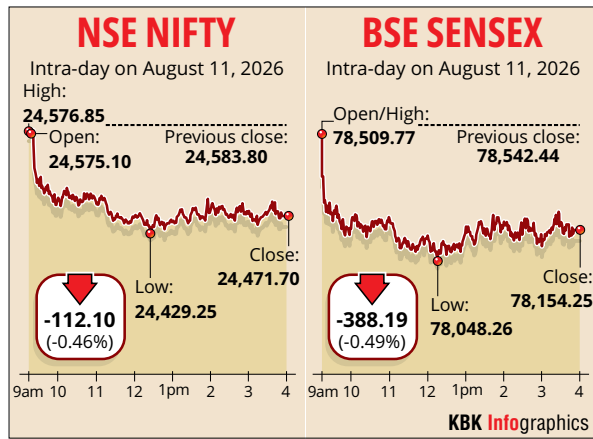
beneficiaries, garnering net inflows of Rs 1,19,066 crore, followed by overnight funds at Rs 40,413 crore and money market funds at Rs 21,180 crore.

"The sharp reversal in debt flows was led by strong inflows into liquid, overnight and money market funds, even as longer-duration categories remained under pressure. This suggests that investors continue to value liquidity and flexibility in their debt portfolios rather than making a broad-based shift towards taking duration risk," said Varun Gupta, CEO, Groww Mutual Fund.

"The industry's assets under management rose 4.3 per cent month-on-month to Rs 85.76 lakh crore at the end of July, from Rs 82.22 lakh crore at the end of June, said Venkat Chalasani, Chief Executive, Amfi.

Gold ETFs also continued to attract investor interest, recording net inflows of Rs 1,559 crore in July, although this was less than half the Rs 3,443 crore garnered in June.

Markets decline amid elevated crude prices, Sensex drops 388 pts



OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 11

Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Tuesday as a sharp rally in crude oil prices due to geopolitical uncertainties dented investors' sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 388.19 points, or 0.49 per cent, to settle at 78,154.25. During the day, it tanked 494.18 points, or 0.62 per cent, to 78,048.26.

The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 112.10 points, or 0.46 per cent, to end at 24,471.70.

From the Sensex pack, UltraTech Cement, Axis Bank, InterGlobe Aviation, Bharti Airtel, Bajaj Finance and Power Grid were among the major laggards.

Eternal, Infosys, Titan, HCL Tech, and Tata Consultancy Services were the gainers.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.18 per cent to \$89.63 per barrel.

"Markets traded under pressure on Tuesday, extending their cautious tone amid renewed geopolitical concerns and rising crude oil prices. Investor sentiment remained subdued amid a renewed rise in crude oil prices, with Brent crude moving towards the USD 90 per barrel mark as hopes of an early US-Iran agreement faded," Ajit Mishra - SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

The BSE SmallCap Select index edged higher by 0.38 per cent, while

THE BSE SMALLCAP SELECT INDEX EDGED HIGHER BY 0.38%, WHILE MIDCAP SELECT INDEX ENDED marginally lower by 0.01%

MidCap Select index ended marginally lower by 0.01 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, Hospitals dropped 1.82 per cent, realty (1.03 per cent), FMCG (0.87 per cent), commodities (0.80 per cent), power (0.54 per cent) and capital goods (0.47 per cent).

Focused IT, Housing Finance, IT, Energy and Consumer Discretionary were the winners.

"A sharp rebound in crude prices shifted market attention back to inflation risks, tempering investor enthusiasm despite a supportive earnings backdrop. Concerns over the disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and the US-Iran negotiations kept sentiment guarded, particularly ahead of key inflation prints in India and the US," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, said.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 1,974.76 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

On Monday, the Sensex was up 43.27 points, or 0.06 per cent, and settled at 78,542.44.

The Nifty went up marginally by 13.15 points, or 0.05 per cent, to end at 24,583.80.

DVC Chief calls for HR Excellence in PSEs at CII summit

He highlighted the 5 Ps - Performance, Process, Persona, Procurement & Preparedness

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, August 11

Public Sector Enterprises (PSEs) need to strengthen human capital and HR practices alongside organisational growth to remain competitive in a rapidly changing business environment, Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC) Chairman and Managing Director Rajesh Pandey said.

Addressing the CII PSE Purva Pragati Summit 2026 in Kolkata, Pandey said PSEs must provide employ-



ees with opportunities for recruitment, training and career mobility to enable them to grow with their

organisations.

He identified the 5 Ps - Performance, Process, Persona, Procurement

and Preparedness for the Future - as key focus areas for improving organisational effectiveness and building future-ready PSEs.

CII Eastern Region Chairman and Tega Industries Managing Director and Group CEO Mehul Mohanka said 87 per cent of organisations in the country are already using artificial intelligence (AI). He said digital technologies are creating opportunities across sectors, including mining and steel, particularly in predictive maintenance and

decision-making.

Mohanka said industrial competitiveness must go beyond quality to include efficiency, workforce readiness, connectivity and continued investment in research and development. He also called for greater collaboration among the government, PSEs and private industry.

CII West Bengal State Council Chairman Rupak Barua said India is projected to grow 6.4 per cent in 2026 and 6.7 per cent in 2027, retaining its position

as the world's fastest-growing major economy.

Hindustan Copper CMD Anupam Misra said HR excellence begins with caring for employees, while Balmer Lawrie CMD Adhip Nath Palchaudhuri highlighted the need for HR strategies to adapt to AI-driven digital transformation.

A status paper titled "Advancing HR Excellence, Labour Compliance & Industrial Competitiveness in Digital Era" was also unveiled at the summit.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Saikat Chakraborty, Chief Manager (Corporate Communications), GAIL (India) Ltd, has been conferred the prestigious Dr CVN-Public Relations Society of India (PRSI) 'Best PR Manager of the Year (2025-26)' Award. The award was presented by Dr G Vivek Venkataswamy, Hon'ble Minister for Labour, Employment, Training & Factories, and Mines & Geology, Government of Telangana, at a ceremony held in Hyderabad



GODREJ FINANCE

GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED

Registered Office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai- 400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, R- 5, Green Park (M), Near Haldiram's, New Delhi- 110016

DEMAND NOTICE

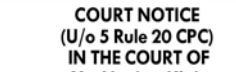
Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Godrej Finance Limited under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) (the "said Borrower(s)"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice(s) issued to them that are also given below. In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower(s) to pay to Godrej Finance Limited, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest as detailed in the said Demand Notice(s), from the date(s) mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrower(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to Godrej Finance Limited by the said Borrower(s) respectively.

Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) Loan Account Number	Demand Notice Date, Amount and NPA Date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1. Mr. Prashant Godara, Flat No. 472, NAV Sansad Vihar, CGHS Ltd., Plot No. 4, Dwarka Sec 22, New Delhi- 110077, Also at , Ground and First Floor, Kh-84/1/18, RZ-F-16A, Palam Dabri Road, Mahavir Enclave, West, New Delhi- 110045	05.08.2026 Rs. 5,07,23,605/-	Property No.1: Property Being Freehold Residential Flat Bearing No. 472, In The Layout Plan of The Nav Sansad Vihar, Cgshs Ltd., Built Up on Plot No.4, Sector 22, Dwarka, New Delhi 110075 And The Boundaries For The Same Are:-, East: Na, West: Na, North: Na, South: Na
2. V D Automobiles LLP, Flat No. 472, NAV Sansad Vihar, CGHS Ltd., Plot No. 4, Dwarka Sec 22, New Delhi- 110077, 3. Mrs. Bhawna Godara, Flat No. 472, NAV Sansad Vihar, CGHS Ltd., Plot No. 4, Dwarka Sec 22, New Delhi- 110077	(INR Five Crore Seven Lakhs	Property No.2: Property Being Freehold Residential Plot No. DVP- A2/9, DLF Valley, Sector 3 of Pinjore Kalka Urban Complex, Panchkula, Haryana-134105 And The Admeasuring 250 Sq.mtrs.
4. Mr. Rajendra Godara, Flat No. 472, NAV Sansad Vihar, CGHS Ltd., Plot No. 4, Dwarka Sec 22, New Delhi 110077, Also at , Ground and First Floor, Kh-84/1/18, RZ-F-16A, Palam Dabri Road, Mahavir Enclave, West, New Delhi- 110045	Twenty Three Thousand Six Hundred and Five Only	
5. Ms V D Auto Wheels, Ground and First Floor, Kh-84/1/18, RZ-F-16A, Palam Dabri Road, Mahavir Enclave, West, New Delhi- 110045	01.08.2026	

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to Godrej Finance Limited as aforesaid, Godrej Finance Limited shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of Godrej Finance Limited. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made there under, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: August 12, 2026
Place: New Delhi, Haryana

(Authorised Officer)
Godrej Finance Limited



COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)

IN THE COURT OF

Ms. Navjeet Klair

Additional District and Sessions Judge-III Sirsa

Next Date, Purpose of case, Orders and Judgments as well as other case information is available on <http://ecourts.gov.in>

Bhim Soan

Vs.

Risal Singh

CNR No. HR5101-09888-2024

Next Date:- 09-08-2026

CA-296-2024

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:

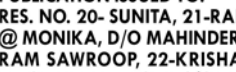
RES. NO. 20- SUNITA, 21-RAEETA @ MONIKA, D/O MAHINDER S/O RAM SAWROOP, 22-KRISHANA, 23- SAMIR, 24- MONU S/O KEWAL S/O RAM SAWROOP, 25-SAPNA, 26-SUMAN D/O SHER SINGH S/O RAM RAKH, 27- RACHAN D/O SHER SINGH, 28-TARA CHAND S/O MANPHOOL S/O BASTI RAM, 29-GUDDI DEVI, 30-VINOD KUMAR S/O BALWANT, 31-RIPUDHMAN, 32-PARDEEP KUMAR, 33- SATBIR SINGH. 34-NIRMALA DEVI D/O HEERA S/O HUKMA, 35-LAL CHAND, 36-BHIM SAIN S/O DUDDA S/O HUNTA, 37-RAJINDER KUMAR, 38-RANVIR S/O HARDWARI LAL S/O DUDDA RAM, 39- BOGHI DEVI WIDOW, 40-BEBO DAUGHTER, 41-KARAMJIT SINGH, 42- SANDEEP KUMAR, S/O VISHVAMITER, 43-KAMLA DEVI WIDOW OF PIRTHI RAJ, 44-JAGDEV SINGH, 45-JASWANT SINGH S/O PIRTHI RAJ, 46-MATHRO DEVI, 47-PREM LALA, 48-CHARMA DEVI, 49-SARITA D/O PRITHI RAJ S/O BHINJURAM, 50-SHANTI DEVI, 51-UGGARSAIN 52-PARVEEN, 53- MAMKAURI, 54-URMILA, D/O KRISHAN LAL S/O BHIRA RAM, 55- SHARDHA DEVI, 56-MAMTA, 57-PRIYANKA, 58-NISHAN, 59-VISHAL S/O BHARAT SINGH S/O KRISHAN LAL, 60-NEELAM, 61-RAYNEET KUMAR, S/O KAUSHALYA DEVI D/O KRISHAN, 62-DHANRAJ S/O MADAN LAL S/O HARLAL, 63-JASWANT S/O MADAN LAL, S/O HARLAL, 64-PAPPU S/O DUNNI CHAND S/O BIRBAL RAM, 65(ii)-BIRMA DEVI, 65(ii)- MOHABBAT RAM @ SUDHIR, 68-BHOOP SINGH, 69-SATISH, 70- ANOOP SINGH S/O HET RAM S/O DEVI LAL, 71- INDRA DEVI WIDOW OF SURENDER, 72- HITESH, 73-SOURAV S/O SURENDER, 74-SANDEEP, 75- SUNIL SONS OF AJIT SINGH, S/O DEVI LAL, ALI R/O VILLAGE BANWALA, TEHSIL KALANWALI, DISTRICT SIRSA.

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 09-10-2026 at 10.00 a.m.

For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2mod> = district notice & district = Sirsa

Sd/- Ms. Navjeet Klair
Additional District and Sessions Judge-III Sirsa

dated 10.08.2026



COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)

IN THE COURT OF

Ms. Deepthi

Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Sonipat, Sonipat
Naresh Kumar

General Public

CNR No. HR5002-000962-2026

Next Date:- 11-09-2026

Prayed that the succession certificate may kindly be issued to the petitioner

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:

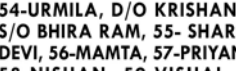
General Public

Sonipat, Haryana

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 11-09-2026 at 10.00 am.

For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2trs> = district notice & district = Sonipat

Sd/- Ms. Deepthi
Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Dated 11.08-2026 Sonipat



COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)

(SUCCESSION CASE)

IN THE COURT OF Ms. Taranjit Kaur

Principal Judge Family Court, CHARKHI DADRI

Bablu

Vs.

General Public and others

GW/15/2025

CNR No. HRCDD01-003703-2025

Next Date:-02-11-2026

NOTICE TO:

General Public and others :-

Charkhi Dadri

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 02-11-2026 at 10.00 am.

For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2mod> = district notice & district = Charkhi Dadri

Sd/- Ms. Taranjit Kaur
Principal Judge Family Court
Dated 07.08.2026 Charkhi Dadri



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Jai Singh @Chirag** S/o Laxman R/o A-1/134 Madandir, Ambedkar Nagar, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 28902/2024 U/s 305(b)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Jai Singh @Chirag** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jai Singh @Chirag** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Jai Singh @Chirag** in **FIR No. 28902/2024 U/s 305(b)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026**.

By order

Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate-02 First Class South East
Room No. 513
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Jyoti W/o Karam Chand R/o Gali No. 14, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 345/21 U/s 33/38 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Jyoti** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jyoti** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Jyoti** in **FIR No. 345/21 U/s 33/38 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By order

Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Salman, S/o: Mohd. Arif, R/o: H.No. D-55, Gali No. 18, Chauhan Bangar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 179/2015, U/s: 380/457/411/34 IPC, Police Station Jafrabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Salman** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Salman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Salman of Police Station Jafrabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.09.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Ld. JMFC-05, Shahdara,
2nd Floor, Room No. 207,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi



NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida G.B. Nagar (U.P)

Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.com

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.com & <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **06/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET**, Annual Maint. of Fountain Sector-56 & Crossing Gijhore 23/54/33/53, Noida (04 Nos Fountain) Cost Rs. 19.25 Lacs.

2. **15/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET**, Shifting of Transformer S.G.-02, Sector-63, Noida. Cost Rs. 25.03 Lacs.

3. **24/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET**, Providing of 4 Mtr Decorative pole in Sector-23, Noida. Cost Rs. 23.47 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: 18.08.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 19.08.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office General Manager (E&M)

Sector-96 Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Zuber, S/o Hakim, R/o B-1222, Gali No. 13, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 969/2015, U/s 380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Zuber** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Zuber** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Zuber** accused of **FIR No. 969/2015, U/s 380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Shruti Saraswat

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North-East District, Room No. 22, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, **Upender, S/o Satbir R/o H.No 03, Gali No. 3, Linepar Bahadurgarh, District Jhajjar, Haryana, Also At: Village Badali, PS Atrali, District Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh Also At: H.No. 02, Gali No. 03, Chotu Ram Nagar, Linepar Bahadurgarh, District Jhajjar, Haryana, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No.:67/2020, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms Act, registered at P.S.: Mundka, Delhi, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Upender**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Upender**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Upender, FIR No:67/2020, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms Act, registered at P.S.: Mundka, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.**

By Order

Sh Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
West Distt., Room No. 355
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi



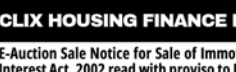
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURAKSHA SANHITA

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sumit @ Chhamiya S/o Ramdev R/o H. No. I-1704, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 157/2024 u/s 25/54 Arms Act at P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sumit @ Chhamiya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sumit @ Chhamiya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sumit @ Chhamiya** accused of FIR No. 157/2024 u/s 25/54 Arms Act at P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **29.10.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Amardeep Kaur,

Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate (North),
Room No. 117,
Rohini Courts, Delhi



CLIX HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Registered Office: W2/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008

"APPENDIX-IV-A" (See proviso to rule 9(1))
Sale notice for sale of Immovable Properties

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the CLIX Housing Finance Limited (CLIX) (Secured Creditors), the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of CLIX Housing Finance Limited (CLIX), Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" basis on **31-Aug-2026**, for recovery of amount as mentioned below, due to the Secured Creditors from following Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) and Corporate Guarantor(s). The reserve price and earnest money to be deposited is mentioned below respectively.

Name of Borrower, Co-Borrower/ Guarantor(s) with addresses	Description & Owner(s) of Properties
1. Ashok Mehta, Both At - 133, 2nd Floor Ram Nagar, Delhi-Front Side Rts Portion With Roof Mip Plot No. C 213 Area 550 Square Feet I.E. 110051, Also At: 71 B, Gali No. 4, Gopal Park, Krishna Nagar, 51.09 Square Meters In SIF Ved Vihar, Hadbast Village Sadullabad Pargana And East Delhi-110051. Loan Ac No. (AC2020011014613) (Along Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad, Bounded As Under: East: Plot No. C-206, West: with future interest and charges accruing after 03.04.2025 Road 9 Meter Wide, North: Plot No. C 214, South: Plot No. C 212. (Type Of Possession & Date - Physical & 27-Nov-2025)	All The Part And Pieces Of One Kita Residential Flat No. S1-1 Second Floor

Reserve Price (RP) & EMD & Incremental Amount	Recovery Amount as per Demand Notice	Date & Time of On-Site Inspection of Property	Date & Time of E-Auction with unlimited extensions of 5 Minutes each
Rs. 11,00,000/- & Rs. 1,10,000/- & Rs. 10,000/-	Rs. 17,35,792.2/- as on 03.04.2025	25.08.2026 From: 10:00 AM to 05:00 PM	31-Aug-2026 11 Am to 1 Pm (with unlimited extensions of 5 Minutes each)

EMD amount shall be remitted through Demand Draft/ NEFT / RTGS / Funds Transfer in favour of "CLIX Housing Finance Limited", Bank Name - ICICI Bank, IFSC Code - ICIC0003419, Account No - 341905000653

Last date for deposit of EMD and uploading Bid documents: 30-Aug-2026 Till 12.00 PM at www.bankauctions.com

The balance 25% of final purchase price minus EMD Amount shall be deposited by the successful bidder, latest by the next working day by way of Demand Draft/ NEFT / RTGS / Funds Transfer in the E-Auction account of CLIX. The balance 75% of the final purchase shall be deposited by way of Demand Draft/ NEFT / RTGS / Funds Transfer within 15 days from the date of auction in the same E-Auction account as above. The refund of EMD to the unsuccessful bidders shall be made only in the account number mentioned by such bidder in the Bid form within 5 working days. **Terms and Conditions - E-auction is being held on "AS IS WHERE IS" and "AS IS WHAT IS" and "WHATEVER THERE IS" basis and will be conducted "Online".** The auction will be conducted through CLIX's approved service provider (Civta Pvt. Ltd.) at the web portal www.bankauctions.com. Bid Documents, Declaration, General Terms and Conditions of online auction sale are available in www.bankauctions.com. To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer, there is no encumbrance on the properties. However, the intending bidders should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of properties put on auction and claims/rights / dues affecting the property/ies, prior to submitting their bid, in this regard, the e-auction advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of CLIX. For any details with respect to any help, procedure and on-line training in regard of the auction process please contact Mr. Nikhil Kumar 7053869593, E mail ID: delhi@clixindia.com, for any details regarding the property please contact +91-7291981124 / 25. It may please be noted that in case of any discrepancy/ inconsistency between auctions notices published in English and in Hindi then the contents of the notice published in English shall prevail. The Authorised Officer/ Secured Creditor shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/ rights/ dues. The sale shall be subject to rules/ conditions prescribed under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002.

Place: Ghaziabad, Date: 12.08.2026

Authorized Officer, CLIX Housing Finance Pvt. Ltd.



CLIX HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Registered Office: W2/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008

NOTICE OF SALE THROUGH PRIVATE TREATY

SALE OF MOVABLE & IMMOVABLE ASSETS CHARGED TO CLIX HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT).

The Authorised Officer of CLIX Housing Finance Limited (hence will be known as "CLIX") has taken over possession of the schedule property(ies) u/Section 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act. Public at large is informed that the secured property(ies) as mentioned in the Schedule are available for sale through Private Treaty, as per the terms agreeable to the CLIX for realisation of CLIX's dues on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS"** and **"AS IS WHAT IS BASIS"** and **"WITHOUT RECOURSE BASIS"**

SR. NO.	Name of the owner of the property (Title Deed holder/s) / Demand Notice amount	Encumbrances known, if any	Reserve Price (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)
1.	PAWAN KUMAR MEHTA S/O LATE BAL KISHAN, P. NO.-53, F/F, RIGHT SIDE, GALI NO. 3, EAST AZAD NAGAR, DELHI-110051. ALSO AT: C-12-B, GALI NO. 1, KANTI NAGAR EXTN. KRISHNA NAGAR EAST DELHI-110051. ALSO AT: W/2708-B PLOT NO. M-15 KHASRA NO. 4, BHABHI COLONY SHAHDARA EAST DELHI-110032. 2. JYOTI RANI W/O PAVAN KUMAR MEHTA, P. NO.-53, F/F, RIGHT SIDE, GALI NO. 3, EAST AZAD NAGAR, DELHI-110051. ALSO AT: B-40, GALI NO. 4, KANTI NAGAR EXT. KRISHNA NAGAR, EAST DELHI-110051. 3. SHRI DURGA ART JEWELLERS THROUGH ITS PROPRIETOR, C-40, GALI NO. 3, KANTI NAGAR EXT. EAST DELHI, DELHI-110051. LOAN NO. -H0EMLM000000040 (Along with future interest and charges accruing after 13.11.2024 till the total realization of the loan amount)	On as is where is basis	Rs. 18,50,000/-	1,85,000/-

1. Description of the Property - "PROPERTY BUILT UP ENTIRE SECOND FLOOR WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, UP TO THE EXTENT OF CEILING LEVEL, BEARING PROPERTY NO. IV/2708-B, BUILT ON PART OF PLOT NO. M-15, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 549 MIN, FITTED WITH ELECTRICITY AND WATER TAB CONNECTION ALONGWITH THE CONCERNED METERS, WITH COMMON RIGHTS OF USE THE ENTRANCE, PASSAGE, STAIRS, WITH UNDIVIDED, UNDIVIDED, IMPORTABLE PROPORTIONATE, OWNERSHIP RIGHTS, IN THE LAND, WITH THE WATER TANKY WHICH IS INSTALLED ON THE ROOF OF THE TOP FLOOR OF THE BUILDING AND HAVING THE RIGHTS TO GO FOR THE INSPECTION OF THE SAME AT ANY REASONABLE TIME, SITUATED AT VILLAGE CHANDRAWALI ALIAS SHAHDARA IN THE ABADI OF GALI NO. 4, BEHABI COLONY, ILAQA SHAHDARA, DELHI-110032. HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE SAID PROPERTY, AND BOUNDED AS UNDER:- EAST: ROAD 15 FT, WIDE NORTH: OTHERS PROPERTY WEST: OTHERS PROPERTY SOUTH: OTHERS PROPERTY."

Standard terms & conditions for sale of property through private treaty are as under: (1). Sale through Private Treaty will be on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS"** and **"AS IS WHAT IS BASIS"** and **"WITHOUT RECOURSE BASIS"**. (2). The purchaser will be required to deposit 25% of the sale consideration on the next working day of receipt of CLIX's acceptance of offer for purchase of property and the remaining amount within 15 days thereafter. EMD amount shall be remitted through Demand Draft/ NEFT / RTGS / Funds Transfer in favor of "Entry-CLIX Housing Finance Limited", Bank Name - ICICI Bank, IFSC Code - ICIC0003419, Account No - 341905000653. (3). The purchaser has to deposit 10% of the offered amount along with application which will be adjusted against 25% of the deposit to be made as per clause (2) above. (4). Failure to remit the amount as required under clause (2) above will cause forfeiture of amount already paid including 10% of the amount paid along with application. (5). In case of non-acceptance of offer of purchase by the CLIX, the amount of 10% paid along with the application will be refunded without any interest. (6). The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances whether known or unknown to the CLIX. The Authorised Officer / Secured Creditor shall not be responsible in any way for any third-party claims / rights / dues. (7). The purchaser should conduct due diligence on all aspects related to the property (under sale through private treaty) to his satisfaction. The purchaser shall not be entitled to make any claim against the Authorised Officer/ Secured Creditor in this regard at a later date. (8). The CLIX reserves the right to reject any offer of purchase without assigning any reason. (9). In case of more than one offer, the CLIX will accept the highest offer. If higher bidder fails to deposit the remaining amount in terms of clause (2) above then CLIX may request to accept the second highest offer. (10). The interested parties may contact the Authorised Officer Mr. Nikhil Kumar 7053869593, E mail ID: delhi@clixindia.com, for any details regarding the property please contact +91-7291981124 / 25. It may please be noted that in case of any discrepancy/ inconsistency between auctions notices published in English and in Hindi then the contents of the notice published in English shall prevail. The Authorised Officer/ Secured Creditor shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/ rights/ dues. The sale shall be subject to rules/ conditions prescribed under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

DATE : 12.08.2026, Place : Delhi NCR

Authorized Officer, CLIX Housing Finance Limited



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Kanachak, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Shamsheer Kumar S/O Sain Dass R/O Sukha Pakhian, Tehsil Marh, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 215/1991 U/S 307, 452, 324, 34 RPC of P/S Kanachak, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/ still absconded. Moreover, the Hon'ble Court has also issued General Warrant of arrest U/S 512 Cr.P.C in respect of said accused person.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Shamsheer Kumar
S/O	: Sain Dass
Address	: Sukha Pakhian, Tehsil Marh, Jammu
Height	: 5' 6"
Complexion	: Wheatish
Eyes	: Black
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-	
1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807,0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in	
3.PCR Jammu	:0191-2605949
4.SP Rural Jammu	: 0191-2605949
5.SDPO Domana	:0191-2604220
6.PS Kachnachak	:0191-2615244

Sd/- Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-7877/26



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Allauddin, S/o. Aslam, R/o.: H.No.C-557, 3rd Floor, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.680/2023 U/S 380/411 IPC** registered at **P.S Jahangir Puri, North West District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Allauddin** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Allauddin** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Allauddin**, accused of **FIR No.680/2023 U/S 380/411 IPC, P.S Jahangir Puri, North West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026**.

By Order, Sh. Sahil Gupta

Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North
North District, Room No.6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **1. Vinod, 2. Rahul @ Sandeep**, both S/o: Lt. Rohtash, both R/o: B-6/58, JJ Colony, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 139/2024, U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, U/s P.S.: Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Vinod, 2. Rahul @ Sandeep** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Vinod, 2. Rahul @ Sandeep** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **1. Vinod, 2. Rahul @ Sandeep** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 139/2024, U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, U/s P.S.: Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 06,Rohini Court, Delhi



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: **Ompal, S/o. Ram Sanchi, R/o.: H.No.B-132, Gali No.6, A-Block, Jagatpuri, Shahdara, Delhi Also at: Village Bahora, Tehsil Patiyal, Kasganj, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.296/2022** registered at **P.S Karol Bagh,**

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

- 1) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. DL1LAL3175-YOM- 2023
 - 2) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. HR46G9111-YOM - NA
 - 3) MAH VEERO15XXL
REG. NO. DL1LAR0411 -YOM - NA
 - 4) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. DL1LAR2655-YOM-2025
 - 5) TATA MOTORS TACEGOLD
REG. NO. DL1LAL19901-YOM- 2023
 - 6) EICHR_VECV EICPRO2114
REG.NO. HR55AL7533-YOM -2022
 - 7) TATA MOTORS SIGN5530FB
REG. NO. HR58D4509-YOM - NA
 - 8) TATA MOTORS TACEGOLD
REG. NO. UK14CA5862-YOM- NA
 - 9) TATA MOTORS TATA_4023
REG. NO. PB13BT3015-YOM-2015
 - 10) TATA MOTORS TATA318TC
REG. NO. UP11BT4060-YOM-2019
 - 11) TATA LPT709CH
REG. NO. DL1LAD7033 -YOM-2020
 - 12) TATA MOTORS TACEGOLCNG
REG. NO. DL1LAN0182-YOM -NA
 - 13) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. DL1LAN1601-YOM- 2024
 - 14) MARUTIS SUPERCARRY
REG. NO. DL1LAJ8062-YOM -2023
 - 15) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. DL1LAM8657-YOM- 2024
 - 16) TATAMOTORS T_INTRAV20
REG. NO.DL1LAN2518-YOM NASSSS
- UNDER HYPOTHECAION WITH
MIS KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK
IS UNDER SALE IN ITS
"AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION"
INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR
QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT
BRANCH ADDRESS:
KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK
3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7,
SECTOR 125,NOIDA-201313
OR CONTACT : PUNIT PARASHAR
KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD.
CONTACT NO. 8377905498
EMAIL:-punit.parashar@kotak.com

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

ADVERTISEMENT OF TENDER

Batch No- 18/26 dated-07.08.2026

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items:

- Sl. No : 1, Tender No. : 04263633, Brief Description: Set of TPU Ring consisting of 02 item, Quantity: 1334 Set, Due Date : 21.08.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 2, Tender No. : 03263475, Brief Description: Concentric Valve Assy for FRTIPL Make Compressor, Quantity: 115 Nos, Due Date : 21.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 3, Tender No. : 04264864, Brief Description: Secondary spring (outer) for LHB Coaches, Quantity: 123 Nos, Due Date : 24.08.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 4, Tender No. : 03263806, Brief Description: Fire Detection Unit for 3 phase locomotive along with connectors, Quantity: 69 Nos, Due Date : 31.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 5, Tender No. : 11260031, Brief Description: Lubricating Grease for Traction motor Bearing (WAP7, WAG9) (Servo plex SHC-120 Grease in 175 kgs pack), Quantity: 22225 Kgs, Due Date : 14.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 6, Tender No. : 06265003, Brief Description: Supply Installation Testing & Commissioning of 24 port Layer 2 Switch, Quantity: 60 Nos, Due Date : 07.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 7, Tender No. : 07265059A, Brief Description: HVN-66 insulating Cut Liner, Quantity: 95100 Nos, Due Date : 14.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 8, Tender No. : 07265096, Brief Description: HVN-66 insulating Cut Liner, Quantity: 89600 Nos, Due Date : 21.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 9, Tender No. : 14264726, Brief Description: Set of VRLA Battery 110V 70AH Consisting of 9 Modules of 12V each suitable for LHB AC Coaches, Quantity: 270 Set, Due Date : 31.08.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Sl. No : 10, Tender No. : 07265058A, Brief Description: HVN-66 insulating Cut Liner, Quantity: 126300 Nos, Due Date : 28.09.2026, Due Time : 14:00
- Note: All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenders are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in. All corrigendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.
- AMM Cum-Secy to PCMM
E.C. Railway, Hajipur
PR/0696/HQ/STORE/T/26-27/80

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Auction Notice

On behalf of president of India, DRM (Commercial), E.C Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya invites e-auction for leasing of parcel space in SLR Coach of under mentioned Coaching trains originating over Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya division. Details are as under: - (1) Name of work with Train No. and completion period : AA/1 : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 13024 (Ex Gaya to HWH) GAYA- Howrah Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No. : SLR-LEASE-26-8, E-Auction Lot No. : 13024-SLR-F1-GAYA - HWH-25-1, Date and Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs. and close at 12:30 hrs. on 21.08.2026. Name of work with Train No. and completion period : AA/2 : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 13697 (Ex Gaya to DLI) GAYA- DLI Amrit Bharat Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No. : SLR-LEASE-26-8, E-Auction Lot No. : 13697-SLR-F1-GAYA - DLI-25-1, Date and Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs. and close at 12:40 hrs. on 21.08.2026. Name of work with Train No. and completion period : AA/3 : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 12397 (Ex Gaya to NDLS) GAYA- NEW DELHI Mahabodhi Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No. : SLR-LEASE-26-8, E-Auction Lot No. : 12397-SLR-F1-GAYA - NDLS-25-1, Date and Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs. and close at 12:50 hrs. on 21.08.2026. Name of work with Train No. and completion period : AA/4 : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (3.9 T) of Train no. 22409 (Ex Gaya to Anand Vihar Terminus) GAYA- ANVT Gareebraath Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No. : SLR-LEASE-26-8, E-Auction Lot No. : 22409-SLR-F1-GAYA -ANVT-25-1, Date and Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs. and close at 13:00 hrs. on 21.08.2026. Name of work with Train No. and completion period : AA/5 : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 12389 (Ex Gaya to MAS) GAYA- Chennai Egmore Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No. : SLR-LEASE-26-8, E-Auction Lot No. : 12389-SLR-F1-GAYA -MAS-25-1, Date and Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs. and close at 13:10 hrs. on 21.08.2026. (2) Website particular where complete details of E-Auction available : www.ireps.gov.in (E-auction Leasing).

Divisional Railway Manager (C), DDU
PR/0702/DDU/COMML/EAN/26-27/72

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84
Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Anurag Vishal, S/o Chitaranjan Gupta, R/o: H. No. C-60 Vijay Vihar, Phase-II, Upper Ground Floor, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in CT No. 7807/2019, PS Rohini, South Distt., Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Anurag Vishal, cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Anurag Vishal, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that Anurag Vishal, the said accused of CT No. 7807/2019, PS Rohini, South Distt., Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 10.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Katariya,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North-West,
Court No. 208, 2nd Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11223/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पेयजल एवंस्वच्छता यांत्रिक नागरिक प्रमण्डल, राँची

अल्पकालीन ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना
निविदा संदर्भ संख्या –DWS/UR/MECH/BOOTY-03/2026-27

क्रम संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रु० में)	अग्रघन राशि (रु० में)	परिमण विवरण का मूल्य (रु० में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	2	4	5	6	7
1	Supplying, Installation, Commissioning and testing of Horizontal Split Casing Centrifugal Pump having discharge of 1932 m ³ /hr against a total head 67 mtrs.with its all required components for Booty Water Supply Pumping Plant Phase-II under D.W. & S. Mechanical Urban Division, Ranchi	8480849.00	169700.00	10000.00	6 Months
2	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :-	दिनांक :-13.08.2026 को 2:00 बजे तक ।			
5	निविदा प्राप्ति (ऑनलाईन विडिंग) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :-	दिनांक :-29.08.2026 को 2:00 बजे तक ।			
6	तकनीकी शीट खोलने की तिथि :-	दिनांक :-01.09.2026 को 2:00 बजे तक ।			
7	तकनीकी शीट खोलने का स्थान:-	अधीक्षण अभियंता का कार्यालय, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता यांत्रिक अंचल, राँची।			
8	निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता यांत्रिक नागरिक प्रमण्डल,राँची (एसवीओआरडी हटिया ब्रांच के पिछे, एचएडसीओ हाई स्कूल कैम्पस, पूर्व, राँची)			
9	ई-प्रोक्योरमेंटकार्यालय का मोबाइल संख्या :-	0651-2400934			
10	कार्यालय का Email Id:-	dwsdmechurbanranchi@gmail.com			

नियम एवं शर्तों आदि विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

—ह—
कार्यपालक अभियंता,
PR 387240 (Drinking Water and Sanitation)26-27°D पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता यांत्रिक नागरिक प्रमण्डल,राँची

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

Running of Additional Trips of Train No. 04123/04124 between Prayagraj Jn.-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Prayagraj Jn. (Bi-Weekly) Special Train

It is notified for the information of rail passengers that Railways have decided to run additional Trips of train no. 04123/04124 between Prayagraj Jn.-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Prayagraj Jn. (Bi-Weekly) Special Train as per the details given below:-

Train No.	From	To	Days to Run	Earlier notified up to	Extension up to	Trips
04123	Prayagraj Jn.	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Sun & Wed	29.07.2026	30.08.2026	08
04124	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Prayagraj Jn.	Mon & Thu	30.07.2026	31.08.2026	08

Accommodation: 1st AC, AC-3 Tier, Sleeper & General. * Rest of other instructions will hold good.

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

Visit RailMadad website : www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in & download Railmadad app.

2772/2026

Please join us on

YouTube Facebook WhatsApp

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

INDIAN RAILWAYS

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Visit us at: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

INDIAN RAILWAYS
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(RAILWAY BOARD)
E-TENDER NO.2026RSI1741TC

Principal Executive Director, Railway Stores (S), Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, Government of India invites e-tender for procurement of 42,396 Nos. Constant Contact Side Bearers (CCSB) for BG bogie wagons to RDSO Specification No. WD-62-Misc.-17 (Rev-1) July-2025 variant B to drawing No. WD-12008-S/1 (Alt-3) for BOXN type wagons (34,076 Nos.) and WD-62-Misc.-17 (Rev-1) July-2025 variant C to drawing No. WD-12007-S/1 (Alt-3) for BOBRN type wagons (8,320 Nos.) through E-Reverse Auction.

2.0 The interested tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://ireps.gov.in> for details of the tender and submission of their e-bids.

3.0 No manual offers will be accepted against e-tender.

4.0 Tender will be closed at 15.00 hours on 14.09.2026.

5.0 Any corrigendum to this tender will be published on the website <http://ireps.gov.in> only and not in print media.

Director, Railway Stores (W),
Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, New Delhi,
For and on behalf of the President of India
2774/26
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER PMGSY (JKRRDA) JAMMU.
NOTICE INVITING e-TENDERS
e-NIT No:-CEJ/PMGSY/ 833 of 2026-27 Dated:- 08/08/2026

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu on behalf of LT Governor of Jammu and Kashmir UT, invites e-tenders on %age Above/Excess (+) OR %age Below/ Less (-) basis (I.e. on Percentage-Rate Basis) from approved and eligible Contractors registered with J&K U.T.Govt, CPWD, Railways or equivalent and other State/U.T.Govts up to 1700 Hrs. on 25-08-2026 for each of the following works

Sr. No.	Name of Work/ Package No.	Name of the PIU	Constt. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Mainnt. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Total (Rs. In Lacs)	Cost of Documents (Rs. In Lacs)	Bid Security (EMD) @2% of total cost rounded to the nearest thousand (Rs. In Lacs)	Time Allowed for completion	Call of tender	Time and date of opening of technical bids	Class of Contractor
1	Construction and Maintenance of Road L025-(Link Road) Khet Prekote road km0.9 to U Kanari Package No. JK1 1-40/1, PMGSY-IV, Batch-I of 2026-27, Block-Wandi, District Poonch (Using Waste Plastics Length 6.000 Kms) Length 6.000Kms Adv. Cost excluding maintenance but inclusive of GST-Rs. 1,257.30 Lacs	Poonch	1257.30	100.58	1357.88	0.20	27.16	15 Months	3 rd	27-08-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/ U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works

Date and Time Schedule

S.No	Particulars	Date	Time
1	Date of issue of tender notice	08-08-2026	1700 hrs
2	Document Download / Sale Start Date	10-08-2026	1855 hrs
3	Pre-Bid Meeting	11-08-2026	1200 hrs
4	Bid submission start date	12-08-2026	1000 hrs
5	Bid submission end date	25-08-2026	1700 hrs
6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	27-08-2026	1100 hrs
7	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed

1. The bidding document can be downloaded from the website and bids shall be submitted ONLINE ONLY in electronic format through the e-tendering portal.
 2. For complete details and instructions, bidders are advised to refer to Standard bidding document(SBD).
 3. For further details and updates, bidders may visit the official website <https://pmgsytendersjk.gov.in>
- No:-CEJ/PMGSY/14487-561
Dated:-08-08-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-7878/26

Sd/-Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu
For and on behalf of The Government of Jammu and Kashmir

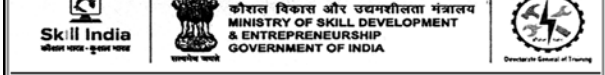
UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
Tender No.661 Date : 11.08.2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of the Dy. General Manager (M&U-Yamuna Valley) UJVN Limited, Hydell Colony, Dhalipur, Dehradun (Uttarakhand) invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
TenderNo-03/DGM(M&U-VY)/UJVNL/2026-27
Name of work : Underwater Inspection of the Water conductor system of 4X30 MW Khodri Hydroelectric Project by Remote-Operated Vehicle (ROV)
Estimated cost: ₹ 4,09,25,100.00 (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid document from website: 13.08.2026 at 16:00 hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 04.09.2026 at 17:00 hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

Dy. General Manager

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship
Notice Inviting Request for Qualification (RFQ)
Tender Ref No: MSDE/PM-SETU/RFQ/01/2026-27

Empanelment of Institutional Partners for Upgradation of ITIs under Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) Scheme.
The Directorate General of Training (DGT) inviting online applications from eligible establishment for empanelment as Institutional Partners for implementation of Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) Scheme for identified Industrial Training Institute (ITI) Clusters on <https://eprocure.gov.in>. The RFQ document is also available on <https://pm-setu.skillingindia.gov.in>. The last date & time for submission of online applications is 31.08.2026 up to 05:00 PM.

Deputy Director
Directorate General of Training (DGT)

Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
720, Kaushal Bhawan, New Moti Bagh,
New Delhi 110023

CBC 63101/11/0008/2627

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER GENERATION CO. LTD.

(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)

No. 03-03/ TN-198/ 1351 Raipur, Dtd 10/ 08/ 2026

E-TENDER NOTICE NO. TN-198/2026-27

Online bids are invited for Supply/ work as mentioned below:-

S. No.	Tender no. /RFx no.	Description	Submission Date & time
1.	HP-252/26-27 8100053413 (With RLA)	Supply of 0.4 KV ACBs/MCCBs and retrofiting in place of old 0.4 KV EE Make: ACB/MCCB/ SFUs of 0.4 KV Unit and Station Auxiliaries Board at 3x40 MW, HBHPS, Machadoli.	03.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs
2.	HW-260/26-27 8100053598 (Without RLA)	Deployment of 60 Nos skilled manpower on contract basis for assisting in operation of conveyors & its auxiliaries round the clock in three shifts of CHP:INT (4x210 MW), HTPS Korba West.	08.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs
3.	HW-261/26-27 8100053596 (With RLA)	RYM work of Fans/Tubular Air Heater/ESP/ Ducts & Dampers of 210 MW ABL Boilers of Unit No.3 & 4, HTSP, Korba West.	08.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs

For details please visit our website <https://espc.co.in> or e-bidding portal:- <https://ebidding.espcel.co.in:50724/iri/portal>

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR(S&P:GEN)
CSPGCL:RAIPUR
Samvad 48723/1

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person Rohit Gupta, S/o: Praveen Gupta, R/o: Jhuggi S-228 Indira Camp-II Sunlight Colony, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case Reg No. 3212/21, FIR No: 222/2016, U/s: 356/379 IPC, PS: Sunlight Colony, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Rohit Gupta, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Rohit Gupta, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person Rohit Gupta, of Case Reg No. 3212/21, FIR No: 222/2016, U/s: 356/379 IPC, PS: Sunlight Colony, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 24.09.2026.

By Order
Divyram Lila
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 508
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/10879/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Ajay S/o Ram Raksha R/o C-41 Sector-16A JJ Colony PKT II Dwarka, New Delhi (II) K-34 PKT II Sector-16A Dwarka JJ Colony, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 398/2020 U/s 392/411/34 IPC PS: Dwarka North, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ajay cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ajay has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ajay accused of FIR No. 398/2020 U/s 392/411/34 IPC PS: Dwarka North, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Katara
JMFC-06, Room No. 514
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/11137/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF PERSONS ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that three accused person namely (1) Meenu Chaudhary Director (2) Dhirender Chaudhary S/o Nagender Choudhary Director of M/s 24 Hours Cake Pvt. Ltd., (3) M/s 24 Hours Cake Pvt Ltd, it's Director/Manager/Principal Officer Add: Kharsa No. 772/1, and 773, S27/9K, DLF-3, Nathpura Gurugram Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CC No. 1995/2021 U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) Meenu Chaudhary (2) Dhirender Chaudhary (3) M/s 24 Hours Cake Pvt Ltd, Director/Manager/Principal Officer can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) Meenu Chaudhary (2) Dhirender Chaudhary (3) M/s 24 Hours Cake Pvt Ltd, Director/Manager/Principal Officer has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused (1) Meenu Chaudhary (2) Dhirender Chaudhary (3) M/s 24 Hours Cake Pvt Ltd, Director/Manager/Principal Officer of CC No. 1995/2021 U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 22.09.2026.

By order
Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
West Distt Room No. 355,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10922/WD/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/653 Date: 10.08.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T.No.: 230-TRD-WC-1042-2026 Advertised value: Rs. 2,07,52,005.64

Description of work: Modification & Shifting of 132 kV TR line due to construction of 4 lane ROB under Kanpur proposed ring road in section Pankidham - Bhaupur section of Prayagraj Division

Bid Security: Rs. 4,15,100.00 Completion Period: 12 Months

Bidding system: Single Packet | Tender Submission date & Time: 02.09.2026 & 14:00 hrs.

Tender Opening date & Time: 02.09.2026 & 15:00 hrs.

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached.

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‘A pattern nowadays’



Farhan Akhtar took a pointed, albeit playful, remark about Ranveer Singh's exit from 'Don 3'

Farhan Akhtar's 'Don 3', which was once supposed to star Ranveer Singh, has not even begun shooting, but the film has been at the centre of a prolonged controversy for months. The controversy surrounding the film began in 2025 when Ranveer Singh reportedly exited the project, just weeks before the film was scheduled to go on floors. What followed was a dispute between the actor and filmmaker, with multiple stakeholders eventually becoming involved in the fallout.

Now, while discussing 25 years of 'Dil Chahta Hai', Farhan appeared to

THE FILMMAKER APPEARED TO DRAW A PARALLEL WITH THE UNCERTAINTY FILMMAKERS CAN FACE TODAY

make a pointed, albeit playful, remark about Ranveer, without mentioning his name.

Farhan was speaking about the difficulties of locking actors' dates for his debut film 'Dil Chahta Hai' in a chat with 'The Hollywood Reporter India'. Recalling how Saif Ali Khan

almost walked out of the project shortly before filming, Farhan said the actor had a scheduling conflict with another film.

"Saif suddenly had some date issue with another film that he was gonna do. The dates shifted and he was kind of half in, half out on that. So, he was in a bit of a spot and he had to leave the film. And everybody tried to convince him, like, 'Yaar, please'. And for me, I was just like, my head was, like, destroyed. Because when we got, when I met him, when we got into it, there was nobody else who could have played that part. It was

just impossible."

Farhan then appeared to draw a parallel with the uncertainty filmmakers can face today. "So, like, that was too heartbreaking for me. Not, maybe 10 days, I think it was maybe about a month away from filming, which seems to be a pattern nowadays," he said, before smilingly adding, "Not just with me. Aisa bhi hota hai. Huh?" While Farhan didn't name Ranveer, the remark inevitably brings the 'Don 3' row to mind, given that the actor's reported exit came only weeks before the film was expected to begin production.

AGENCIES

Ram Gopal Varma returns with 'Police Company'

It is an action-crime drama inspired by true events

Mumbai, Aug 11 (PTI)

Filmmaker Ram Gopal Varma is set to return to the crime and gangster genre with 'Police Company', an action-crime drama inspired by true events, with actor Harshvardhan Rane playing Mumbai's renowned encounter specialist Daya Nayak.

Varma, whose films such as 'Satya', 'Company' and 'Sarkar' have explored the intersections of crime, politics and law enforcement, is returning to familiar territory with the new project, the makers announced on Tuesday. The film, which will go on floors later this month, is backed by Bhushan Kumar's 'T-Series' in association with 'RGV Company Production'.

'Police Company' marks the first collaboration between Kumar and Varma and will explore a chapter in Mumbai's policing history when the underworld had expanded its influence across the city and beyond.

According to the makers, between 1997 and 2004, a special police squad was formed to counter the growing underworld threat and went on to eliminate nearly 300 gangsters.



HARSHVARDHAN RANE WILL PLAY MUMBAI'S RENOWNED ENCOUNTER SPECIALIST DAYA NAYAK

The film will draw inspiration from this period with Daya Nayak at the centre of its story.

Nayak became one of India's most talked-about encounter specialists through his operations against members of the Mumbai underworld, eventually becoming a prominent figure in the city's policing folklore.

'Police Company' is expected to explore the pressures and moral dilemmas faced by police officers working on the frontlines of Mumbai's battle against organised crime.

Jacob Elordi in talks to join cast of 'SCAPEGOAT'

The next feature film to be directed by director Ari Aster

Los Angeles, Aug 11 (PTI)

Hollywood rising star Jacob Elordi is in negotiations to join the cast of 'Scapegoat', the next feature film by acclaimed director Ari Aster.

The filmmaker, known for horror hits such as 'Hereditary', 'Midsommar', 'Beau Is Afraid' and 'Eddington', has once again partnered with studio 'A24', which distributed all of his previous movies.

If finalised, the 'Frankenstein' actor will feature alongside Oscar-nominated star Scarlett Johansson in the project, according to 'Deadline'. Though the official plot of the film has been kept under wraps, there has been a lot of speculation about the movie, with some claiming that it is about a doctor who

ASTER IS KNOWN FOR HORROR HITS 'HEREDITARY' & 'MIDSOMMAR'

operates on an internet-famous person. Others have speculated that the movie is a sci-fi romance. Aster will also produce 'Scapegoat' through his banner 'Square Peg' alongside Lars Knudsen. Elordi has been garnering acclaim for his recent performances, beginning with Guillermo del Toro's 'Frankenstein', which earned him a nomination for an Academy Award for 'Best Supporting Actor'. He was most recently seen in 'Wuthering Heights', filmmaker Emerald Fennell's adaptation of the classic Emily Brontë novel. In the movie, he starred alongside Margot Robbie. The Australian actor also reprised his role of Nate Jacobs in the final season of 'Euphoria'.

Prime Video unveils official trailer of 'Drawn Together'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Los Angeles August 11

Prime Video unveiled the official trailer of 'Drawn Together', its upcoming international 'Original' film based on the successful duology 'Enfrentados' ('Drawn Together' and 'Drawn Apart') written by New York Times and international best-selling author Mercedes Ron. In addition, new images from this romantic thriller have been released, starring Ester Expósito ('Venus') and Hugo Diego García ('The Substance').

'Drawn Together' will release on September 9. The cast is completed by Eric Masip ('Through My Window') as Iván, Pablo Molinero



THE FIRST PART OF THE 'ENFRENTADOS' DUOLOGY FROM MERCEDES RON WILL ARRIVE ON SEPTEMBER 9

('A Private Affair') as Alejandro, Zoe Bonafonte ('The 47') as Gabriela, Lluís Homar ('Los Abrazos Rotos') as Logan and Joaquín Ferreira ('Club

de Cuervos') as Ray. Marfil Cortés, daughter of a Spanish business tycoon, sees her perfect New York life shattered when she's suddenly kidnapped and mysteriously released. As a result, her father assigns the enigmatic Sebastian Moore as her bodyguard. Despite her fierce independence and his professional distance, they find themselves drawn to each other.

AI IN HOLLYWOOD

AI could help get more mid-budget films made: Brad Pitt

Los Angeles, Aug 11 (PTI)

Hollywood star Brad Pitt believes artificial intelligence could help revive mid-budget filmmaking. However, he remains more cautious about the technology being used to replicate actors' performances.

In a new interview with 'Esquire', the Oscar-winning actor said AI, when used as a creative tool, could help bring films with budgets in the range of 40 million dollars to 90 million dollars to the screen by making expensive visual effects more accessible. "There's a lot of pushback against AI, but AI is going to be the very thing that, if used as a tool, is going to help these mid-budget films, 40 to 90 million dollars-budgeted films, get made," Pitt said.



PITT DESCRIBED THE USE OF AI IN MOVIES AS 'GONNA BE A VERY INTERESTING EXPERIMENT', WHILE ALSO DISCUSSING THE INCREASINGLY COMMON PRACTICE OF BODY SCANNING ACTORS FOR VISUAL EFFECTS

However, Pitt said he had more complicated feelings about AI being used to reproduce an actor's performance.

Asked whether AI could replicate one of his performances, he said the outcome would depend on the person directing the technology and the creative choices being made. "Well, it depends on who's creating it, you know? Who's behind it; who's telling the story. Who's saying, 'I want to see this emotion from him' and then being able to mine through whatever AI provides and going, 'More in this direction' and tailoring it in that way," Pitt said. He added, "So, they could, but the final product might not be my choices and what I found and discovered in the thing."

Pitt described the use of AI in movies as 'gonna be a very interesting experiment', while also discussing the increasingly common practice of body scanning actors for visual effects.

Ajay Devgn to host 'Crime Patrol 2026'

The long-running true-crime franchise to premiere on August 31

Mumbai, Aug 11 (PTI)

Ajay Devgn is set to take over as the host of Sony Entertainment Television's long-running true-crime franchise 'Crime Patrol' with its latest season, scheduled to premiere on August 31.

Titled 'Crime Patrol 2026: Crime Ka Current Season', the show will air at 10:30 pm on 'Sony Entertainment Television' and stream on 'Sony LIV'.

Devgn, whose screen image has often been associated with police and action roles in films such as 'Singham', 'Drishyam' and 'Gangajal', will present stories inspired by cases that have shaken the nation. In a

HE SAID JOINING A SHOW LIKE 'CRIME PATROL' FELT LIKE A RESPONSIBILITY TO HIS FANS AND VIEWERS

recently released promo, the actor addresses viewers directly, urging them not to be consumed by fear but to exercise greater caution as they navigate the realities of crime. "Main rahunga aapke saath," Devgn says in the promo, assuring viewers that he will accompany them through the stories.

In a statement, the actor said joining a show like 'Crime Patrol' felt like a responsibility to his fans

and viewers. "The show has built a legacy of understanding crime stories while driving awareness among viewers, encouraging them to become more vigilant about the people around them and who they interact with and trust," Devgn said.

"As we bring to the forefront some of the stories inspired by cases that have shaken the nation, I hope and believe that I can help and guide audiences to navigate them with caution rather than fear," he added.

'Crime Patrol' premiered in 2003 and has evolved through several editions, including 'Crime Patrol Satark', 'Crime Patrol Dastak', 'Crime Patrol Dial 100' and 'Crime Patrol 2.0'.

